Prayer for the One Who Begins

DRAFT — pending clergy/educator review

Original text, not traditional liturgy. Wording lives in book/opening-prayer.txt.

Hineni — here I am.
I did not choose the road that brought me to this page,
but I choose to stand on it now.

I come not because I know, but because I want to know.
I come seeking *or*, light — not the whole of it,
only enough to read the next word.

There is no one among us who holds the whole truth.
We are all still learning the letters.
So I will not ask to be right.
I will ask to be honest,
to be patient with my own mistakes,
and to make a little more right in the world than I found —
tikkun, one letter at a time.

May these sounds, older than any of us,
become mine without ceasing to be ours.
May the voice I find in them be my own.
And when I read aloud with others,
may I feel what every learner before me felt:
not an outsider, but one more voice in the room.

Baruch ha-ba — blessed is the one who arrives.
Let us begin.

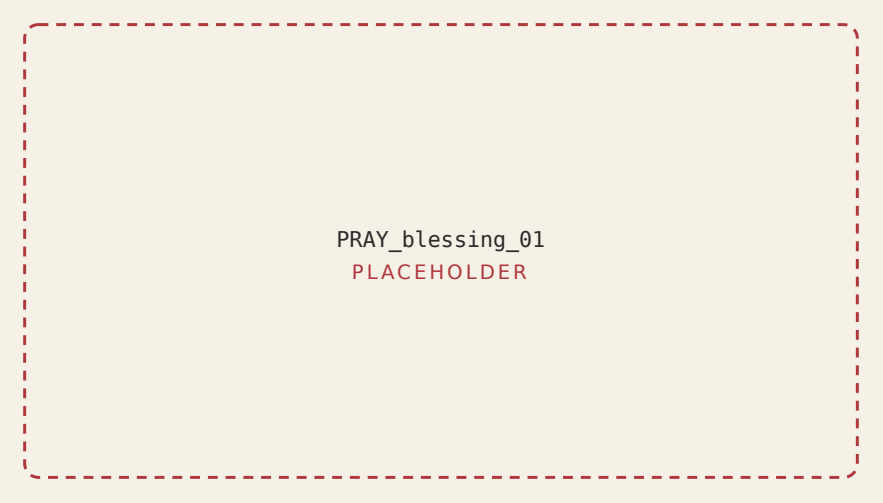
The Priestly Blessing

Numbers 6:24–26. Your first page of Hebrew: fifteen words, thirteen different letters.

יְבָרֶכְךָ יְהוָה וְיִשְׁמְרֶךָ׃

יָאֵר יְהוָה פָּנָיו אֵלֶיךָ וִיחֻנֶּךָּ׃

יִשָּׂא יְהוָה פָּנָיו אֵלֶיךָ וְיָשֵׂם לְךָ שָׁלוֹם׃



Source: data/corpus/registry.json (bless-priestly-1, bless-priestly-2, bless-priestly-3). Status: verified; **not proofread by a Hebrew educator**. The divine name is shown as written in the source; it is read aloud as “Adonai”.

How to use this book and the app

Each letter has one page. Look at the picture and find the letter hiding in it. Trace the strokes in the order shown, say the sound, and read the three words. Then scan the code, or type the link, to open the same letter in the companion web app, where you can trace on a screen and hear it. Where a recorded voice is not available yet, the app falls back to your device's own Hebrew voice.

The path: the opening prayer and blessing → the alphabet and its 27 letter pages → the vowels → syllable practice → the prayers (every page has its own code) → survival Hebrew for travel and daily life. Read for the congregation first or for Israel first; both paths use the same letters.

Print and cursive. Every letter page shows the printed letter and the Israeli handwritten (ktav yad) form, each with numbered strokes where the data exists. Handwriting stroke data is marked as draft quality: it still needs a native writer's review.

Which pronunciation? Hebrew is read differently in Israel, in Sephardi tradition and in Ashkenazi tradition. The next page explains the differences. The app lets you choose; American synagogues often use the Sephardi values.

Companion app. The page for any letter is https://alef.example.org/#/letters/<letter> and any prayer is https://alef.example.org/#/read/<text>. **The host "alef.example.org" is a PLACEHOLDER: those links do not work until a real domain is chosen (one value, book/config.json).**

Contents

The Priestly Blessing 2
Pronunciation traditions 4
The alphabet at a glance 6
The 27 letters (22 letters and 5 final forms) 7
Remember every letter 34
The vowels 39
Reading practice: syllables 41
Reading practice: words 42
The Priestly Blessing, word by word 44
Prayers and verses: Shema, Blessing and daily words 45
The Torah service 49
The Amidah, Kedushah and closing prayers 54
Shabbat, Psalms and the table 59
Hanukkah 65
Survival Hebrew 66
Index 78
Colophon, sources and statuses 80

Pronunciation traditions

The same letters, three living ways of reading them aloud. **Israeli** is the everyday Modern Hebrew of Israel and the default of the Israel track. **Sephardi** is the liturgical tradition of Spanish-Portuguese and Mizrahi communities. **Ashkenazi** is the older Central and Eastern European liturgical tradition. The app's *congregation* setting picks one for the prayers. Data: data/pronunciation/*.json.

Where they part

Bet is b with dagesh and v without.

Kaf is k with dagesh and kh (like loch) without.

Pe is p with dagesh and f without.

The dot decides: right dot = sh, left dot = s.

Dagesh kal hardens begadkefat letters (only bet, kaf, pe change sound in Israeli Hebrew). Dagesh chazak (doubling) is not pronounced in Modern Hebrew.

In General Israeli chet and khaf are one sound [χ]; older Mizrahi speakers keep the pharyngeal chet.

In General Israeli ayin is merged with alef. Pharyngeal ayin survives in Sephardi/Mizrahi tradition; Ashkenazi is silent.

Nearly all Israeli Jews pronounce resh as a uvular fricative; the English r is the typical American carry-over.

Ashkenazi tav without dagesh is s (Shabbos); Sephardi and Israeli tav is always t.

Switching from Israeli/Sephardi to Ashkenazi

Kamatz: a becomes o: Where Israeli/Sephardi reads kamatz gadol as a, Ashkenazi reads it as o (aw). Patach stays a. בָּרוּךְ *Barukh / Bawrukh* (blessed); שָׁלוֹם *shalom / sholom* (peace)

Cholam: o stays o, or becomes oy: Choose one value for your community. Most American Ashkenazi readers use o; oy is the Polish/Galician/Chasidic value. אֲדֹנָי *Adonai / Adonoy* (my Lord (the divine name is read this way))

Tzere: e becomes ei: Ashkenazi tzere is a diphthong. Segol stays e. בֵּית *beit / beis* (house of); אֱלֹהֵינוּ *Eloheinu* (our God)

Tav without dagesh: t becomes s: Only tav WITHOUT a dagesh changes. A tav with dagesh is t in every tradition. שַׁבָּת *Shabbat / Shabbos* (Sabbath); יִתְגַּדַּל *Yitgadal / Yisgadal* (may it be magnified (Kaddish))

Stress: last syllable becomes second-to-last: Ashkenazi stress is historically penultimate (SHAB-bos, KID-dush). The sources do not say how consistently American prayer reading follows this; that part is inference. שַׁבָּת *shabBAT / SHABbos* (Sabbath)

Same word, two traditions

Hebrew	Meaning	Israeli	Ashkenazi	What switches
שַׁבָּת	Sabbath	Shabbat	Shabbos	tav, kamatz, stress
בְּרִית	covenant (brit milah)	brit	bris	tav, tzere
אֲדֹנָי	the divine name as read aloud	Adonai	Adonoy	kamatz, cholam
יִתְגַּדַּל	Kaddish, first word	Yitgadal	Yisgadal	tav
בַּת	daughter (bat mitzvah)	bat	bas	tav
אֱמֶת	truth	emet	emes	tav
חָתָן	groom	chatan	chosson	kamatz, tav, stress
בָּרוּךְ	blessed	Barukh	Bawrukh	kamatz
בֵּית	house of	beit	beis	tzere, tav
שָׁלוֹם	peace / hello	shalom	sholom	kamatz, stress

Sounding less like an outsider (Israeli Hebrew)

Resh: back of the throat, not the English r. Common slip: English [ɹ] ("rail") instead of the Israeli uvular [ʁ̞].
Try: Say kar, rishon, horim, rekhev slowly, keeping the tongue tip down behind the lower teeth.

Five pure, short vowels: no glides. Common slip: Diphthongised English vowels (sha-LOHM with an "oh-oo" glide).
Try: Say lo, bo, lu, li, la with no trailing w or y sound; clip them.

Stress usually falls on the last syllable (milra). Common slip: English-habit stress on the first or second syllable.
Try: Clap the syllables and land the clap on the last one.

Silent shva makes consonant clusters. Common slip: Inserting a short vowel in g-dola, k-tana, z-man.
Try: Say zman, then gdola, holding the two consonants together with no vowel between them.

Do not carry shul pharyngeals into Israeli speech. Common slip: Pharyngeal chet and ayin (the strict synagogue sound).
Try: Say chet as a throat-clearing kh, and read ayin as if it were alef.

Less puff on p, t, k. Common slip: Strongly aspirated English [pʰ tʰ kʰ].
Try: Hold a hand in front of your mouth and say pita, toda, kafe with as little breath as you can.

Statuses and source links for each claim are in the data files; the drills are marked there as unreviewed by a native speaker.

The alphabet at a glance

#	Print	Cursive	Name	Sound	Page
01	א		Alef	silent	7
02	ב		Bet / Vet	b / v	8
03	ג		Gimel	g	9
04	ד		Dalet	d	10
05	ה		He	h	11
06	ו		Vav	v	12
07	ז		Zayin	z	13
08	ח		Chet	kh, throat-clearing	14
09	ט		Tet	t	15
10	י		Yod	y	16
11	כ		Kaf / Khaf	k / kh	17
12	ל		Lamed	l	18
13	מ		Mem	m	19
14	נ		Nun	n	20
15	ס		Samekh	s	21
16	ע		Ayin	silent in Tel Aviv, throaty in Mizrahi speech	22
17	פ		Pe / Fe	p / f	23
18	צ		Tsadi	ts	24
19	ק		Kof	k	25
20	ר		Resh	r, Israeli uvular	26
21	ש		Shin / Sin	sh / s	27
22	ת		Tav	t	28
23	ך		Khaf sofit	kh (final)	29
24	ם		Mem sofit	m (final)	30
25	ן		Nun sofit	n (final)	31
26	ף		Fe sofit	f (final)	32
27	ץ		Tsadi sofit	ts (final)	33

Alef

silent

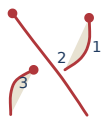
PRINT

א

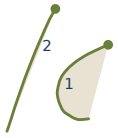
CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

א

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 3 strokes



Cursive: 2 (draft)

L01_alef_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Ox head. The letter's shape: two diagonal horns joined by a slanted body. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/alef

placeholder host, not a live site



אַבָּא

aba

dad

lessons:r07



אִמָּא

ima

mom

lessons:r09

אָז

az

so

phrasebook:fillers-01

HOW IT SOUNDS silent / a glottal stop between vowels (uh-oh). IPA Israeli [ʔ] or ∅. Ashkenazi: silent. Ashkenazi alef is silent at all times in most forms.

Bet / Vet

b / v

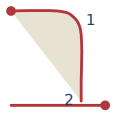
PRINT

ב

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

ק

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 1 (draft)

L02_bet_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Bed inside a house. The letter's shape: a box open to the left with a dot inside. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it:
https://alef.example.org/#/letters/bet

placeholder host, not a live site



בֵּית

beit
house of
lessons:r08



בַּבַּיִת

babayit
in the house
lessons:r33

בֶּאֱמֶת

be'emet?
really?
phrasebook:fillers-06

HOW IT SOUNDS b with dagesh, v without (with dagesh: b as in boy; without dagesh: v as in very). IPA Israeli [b] with dagesh, [v] without. One of the three letters that still alternate in Modern Hebrew.

Gimel

g

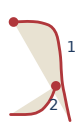
PRINT

ג

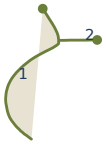
CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

ג

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 2 (draft)

L03_gimel_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Giraffe mid-stride. The letter's shape: a tall stroke with a short foot kicking out to the left. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/gimel

placeholder host, not a live site



גַּן

gan
garden
lessons:r18

גֶּשֶׁם

geshem
rain
lessons:il15

גָּדוֹל

gadol
big
lessons:r18

HOW IT SOUNDS hard g as in game, never soft. IPA Israeli [g]. No alternation in Modern Hebrew. Jewfaq: always a hard g.

Dalet

d

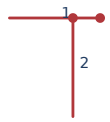
PRINT

ד

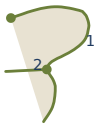
CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

ד

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 2 (draft)

L04_dalet_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Door frame. The letter's shape: a flat lintel with one post hanging from its right end. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/dalet

placeholder host, not a live site

דַּי

dai
enough / stop it
phrasebook:politeness-19

דֶּרֶךְ

derekh
way
lessons:r18

HOW IT SOUNDS d. IPA Israeli [d]. No alternation in Modern Hebrew.

He

h

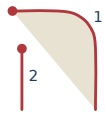
PRINT

ה

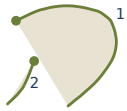
CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

ה

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 2 (draft)

L05_he_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: House with an open window. The letter's shape: a lintel with a right post and a short detached left post leaving a gap at the top. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/he

placeholder host, not a live site



הַיּוֹם

hayom
today
phrasebook:numbers-20

הֵי

hey
hi
phrasebook:greetings-02

הַזָּן

hazan
who feeds
lessons:r47

HOW IT SOUNDS h; silent at the end of a word unless it has mappiq. IPA Israeli [h]. Final he without mappiq is a vowel letter.

Vav

v

PRINT

ו

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

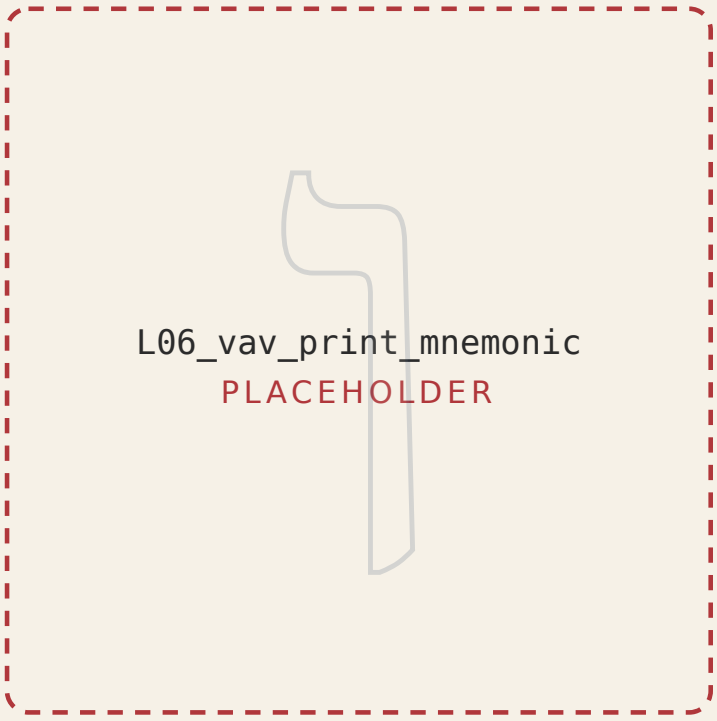
ו

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 1 stroke

Cursive: 1 (draft)



Find it: Vine on a stake. The letter's shape: one straight vertical with a tiny hook at top. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/vav

placeholder host, not a live site

וְוֹאלָה

wallah

really? / wow / honestly

phrasebook:politeness-14

וָעֶד

va'ed

and ever

lessons:r36

וְאֲנִי

ve'ani

and I

lessons:r14

HOW IT SOUNDS v; also the vowel letter for o (cholam malei) and u (shuruk). IPA Israeli [v] (loanwords [w]). As a vowel letter see the cholam/shuruk records.

Zayin

PRINT

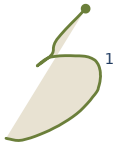
ז

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 1 (draft)



Find it: Zipper pull. The letter's shape: a vertical with a small crossbar crown. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/zayin

placeholder host, not a live site



זָהָב

zahav
gold
lessons:r23

זֶה

zeh
this
lessons:r23

זוֹל

zol
cheap
lessons:il08

HOW IT SOUNDS z. IPA Israeli [z]. Check with a native speaker or phonetics reference. *(standard value; not in the fetched side-by-side table)*

Chet

kh, throat-clearing

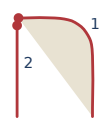
PRINT

ח

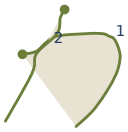
CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

ח

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 2 (draft)

L08_chet_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Hut doorway. The letter's shape: a gateway: two posts with a flat roof, no gap. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/chet

placeholder host, not a live site

ח�ֵצִי

chetsi
half
phrasebook:numbers-18

חָבֵר

chaver
friend
phrasebook:small-talk-18

חוּמוּס

humus
hummus
phrasebook:cafe-16

HOW IT SOUNDS ch as in Bach / loch (back-of-throat, no English chair sound). IPA Israeli [χ] (merged with khaf). General Israeli: chet and khaf merged into one sound. Older Mizrahi speakers keep the pharyngeal. Strict liturgical usage asks for the pharyngeal but it is rarely observed.

Tet

t

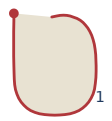
PRINT

ט

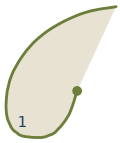
CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

ר

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 1 stroke



Cursive: 1 (draft)

L09_tet_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Teacup with a curled handle. The letter's shape: a bowl whose left rim curls inward. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/tet
placeholder host, not a live site



טוֹב

tov
OK / well / good
phrasebook:fillers-03



טֹבוּ

tovu
good are
lessons:r40

טַל

tal
dew
lessons:r23

HOW IT SOUNDS t. IPA Israeli [t]. General Israeli lost the emphatic sounds of Biblical Hebrew (Wikipedia). Which Sephardi/Mizrahi communities keep emphatic tet was not in our sources. *(standard value; not in the fetched side-by-side table)*

Yod

y

PRINT

י

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

י

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 1 stroke

Cursive: 1 (draft)



Find it: Yo-yo on a short string. The letter's shape: a small comma hanging at the top of the line. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/yod

placeholder host, not a live site



יָמִינָה

yamina

right

phrasebook:directions-07



יֶלֶד

yeled

boy; child

lessons:il14

יַיִן

yayin

wine

phrasebook:cafe-12

HOW IT SOUNDS y as in yes; vowel letter for i/ei. IPA Israeli [j]. Check with a native speaker or phonetics reference. *(standard value; not in the fetched side-by-side table)*

Kaf / Khaf

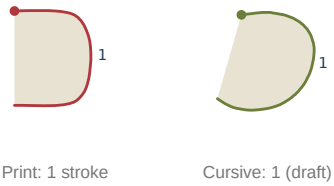
PRINT

כ

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

כ

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 1 stroke

Cursive: 1 (draft)

L11_kaf_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Cupped palm. The letter's shape: a rounded bracket open to the left, like a cupped hand. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/kaf

placeholder host, not a live site

כֵּן
ken
yes
phrasebook:politeness-08

כְּלוֹמַר
klomar
that is / I mean
phrasebook:fillers-11

כִּי
ki
because
lessons:r10

HOW IT SOUNDS k with dagesh; kh (loch) without (with dagesh: k as in kite; without dagesh: kh as in loch). IPA Israeli [k] with dagesh, [χ] without. Khaf is the same sound as chet in General Israeli.

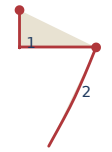
Lamed

ל

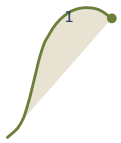
PRINT

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 1 (draft)

L12_lamed_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Lighthouse / shepherd's staff. The letter's shape: the tallest letter, a staff rising above the line with a hooked foot. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/lamed
placeholder host, not a live site



לֶחֶם
lechem
bread
lessons:il07



לַיְלָה
laylah
night
lessons:il17

לֹא
lo
no
phrasebook:politeness-09

HOW IT SOUNDS l. IPA Israeli [l]. Check with a native speaker or phonetics reference. *(standard value; not in the fetched side-by-side table)*

Mem

m

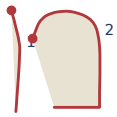
PRINT

מ

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

מ

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 1 (draft)

L13_mem_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Mountain over water (mayim). The letter's shape: a square with a gap at bottom left and a wave-like top. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/mem
placeholder host, not a live site

L13_mem_print_v1
PLACEHOLDER

מַיִם
mayim
water
phrasebook:cafe-09

L13_mem_print_v2
PLACEHOLDER

מֶלֶךְ
melekh
king
lessons:r11

L13_mem_print_v3
PLACEHOLDER

מִשְׁפָּחָה
mishpachah
family
lessons:il14

HOW IT SOUNDS m. IPA Israeli [m]. Check with a native speaker or phonetics reference. *(standard value; not in the fetched side-by-side table)*

Nun

n

PRINT

נ

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

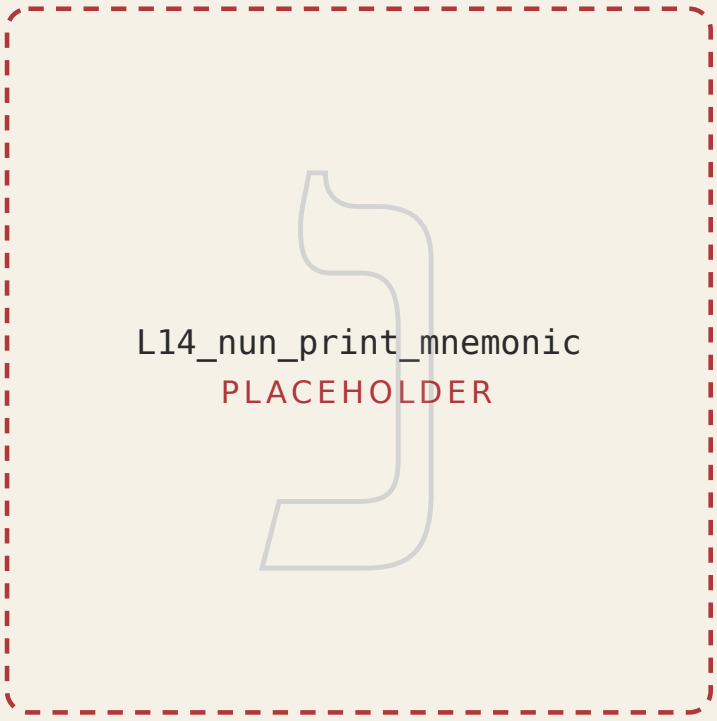
נ

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 1 stroke

Cursive: 1 (draft)



Find it: Nail bent at the top. The letter's shape: a short bent stroke like a seed or a fish. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it:
https://alef.example.org/#/letters/nun

placeholder host, not a live site



נְסִיעָה

nesi'ah

ride; trip

lessons:il10

נוּ

nu

well? / come on

phrasebook:fillers-02

נָכוֹן

nachon

right / correct

phrasebook:fillers-04

HOW IT SOUNDS n. IPA Israeli [n]. Check with a native speaker or phonetics reference. *(standard value; not in the fetched side-by-side table)*

Samekh

S

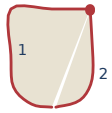
PRINT

ס

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

ס

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 1 (draft)

L15_samekh_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Sun. The letter's shape: a closed round loop. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it:
https://alef.example.org/#/letters/samekh

placeholder host, not a live site

L15_samekh_print_v3
PLACEHOLDER

סָלָט
salat
salad
phrasebook:cafe-20

L15_samekh_print_v1
PLACEHOLDER

סֵפֶר
sefer
book
lessons:r20

L15_samekh_print_v1
PLACEHOLDER

סִדּוּר
sidur
prayer book
lessons:r51

HOW IT SOUNDS s. IPA Israeli [s]. Chabad notes Ashkenazim read an unaccented tav like samekh (see tav).

Ayin

silent in Tel Aviv, throaty in Mizrahi speech

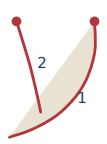
PRINT

ע

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

ע

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 1 (draft)

L16_ayin_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Eye (ayin). The letter's shape: a Y with the left branch curling. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it:
https://alef.example.org/#/letters/ayin

placeholder host, not a live site

עֶזְרָה
ezra!
help!
phrasebook:help-01

עֲשָׂרָה
asara
ten (10)
phrasebook:numbers-10

עֶשְׂרִים
esrim
twenty (20)
phrasebook:numbers-11

HOW IT SOUNDS silent / glottal stop; do not try a pharyngeal in Israel. IPA Israeli [ʔ] or ∅ (merged with alef). Ashkenazi: silent. General Israeli ayin is absorbed by alef. A pharyngeal learned in shul can mark a speaker as an outsider in Israel.

Pe / Fe

p / f

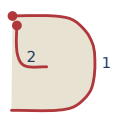
PRINT

פ

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

ﭫ

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 1 (draft)

L17_pe_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Pie in an open mouth. The letter's shape: a coiled mouth with a tooth inside. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/pe

placeholder host, not a live site



פִּיתָה

pita

pita bread

phrasebook:cafe-19

פָּתוּחַ

patuach

open

phrasebook:shop-16

פָּלָאפֶל

falafel

falafel

phrasebook:cafe-17

HOW IT SOUNDS p with dagesh, f without (with dagesh: p as in pie; without dagesh: f as in fun). IPA Israeli [p] with dagesh, [f] without. Aspiration of p/t/k compared with English is unsourced (see drills).

Tsadi

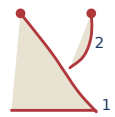
ts

PRINT

צ

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 1 (draft)

L18_tsadi_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Cat sitting (ts of 'cats'). The letter's shape: a kneeling figure, body leaning right with an arm reaching left. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/tsadi
placeholder host, not a live site

צֶדֶק
tzedek
justice
lessons:r24

צְדָקָה
tzedakah
charity; justice
lessons:r24

HOW IT SOUNDS ts / tz as in cats. IPA Israeli [ts].

Kof

k

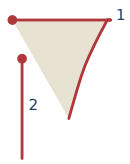
PRINT

ק

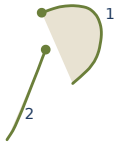
CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

ק

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 2 (draft)

L19_qof_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Kangaroo tail / monkey (kof) hanging. The letter's shape: a rounded top with a long tail dropping below the line. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/qof

placeholder host, not a live site

L19_qof_print_v2
PLACEHOLDER

קוֹל

kol

voice

lessons:r24

L19_qof_print_v1
PLACEHOLDER

קָפֶה

kafeh

coffee

lessons:il06

קַר

kar

cold

lessons:il15

HOW IT SOUNDS k. IPA Israeli [k].

Resh

r, Israeli uvular

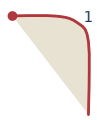
PRINT

ר

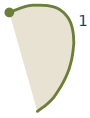
CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

ר

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 1 stroke



Cursive: 1 (draft)

L20_resh_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Rainbow arc / head (rosh). The letter's shape: a single rounded corner, like a bowed head. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/resh
placeholder host, not a live site



רֹאשׁ

rosh
head
lessons:r09



רַכֶּבֶת

rakevet
train
lessons:il10

רֶגַע

rega
one moment
phrasebook:politeness-20

HOW IT SOUNDS back-of-the-throat r (like French or German r), not the English r. IPA Israeli [ʁ] uvular. Nearly all Israeli Jews use a uvular resh. Using the English [ɹ] is a leading outsider marker.

Shin / Sin

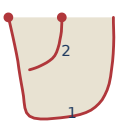
sh / s

PRINT

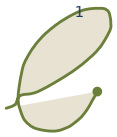
ש

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 1 (draft)

L21_shin_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Shark teeth / three flames. The letter's shape: three prongs rising from a base. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it:
https://alef.example.org/#/letters/shin

placeholder host, not a live site

L21_shin_print_v1
PLACEHOLDER

שָׁלוֹם

shalom
hello / goodbye / peace
phrasebook:greetings-01

L21_shin_print_v2
PLACEHOLDER

שֶׁמֶשׁ

shemesh
sun
lessons:il15

שְׂמאלָה

smola
left
phrasebook:directions-06

HOW IT SOUNDS sh with the right dot, s with the left dot (with shin dot: sh as in shoe; with sin dot: s as in sun). IPA Israeli [ʃ] with right dot, [s] with left dot. Lithuanian Ashkenazi historically merged both as [s] (historical).

Tav

t

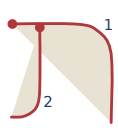
PRINT

ת

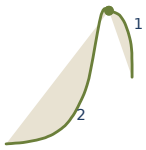
CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

ת

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 2 (draft)

L22_tav_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Table / tent. The letter's shape: a lintel on two legs, the left leg with a foot. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it:
https://alef.example.org/#/letters/tav

placeholder host, not a live site

L22_tav_print_v2
PLACEHOLDER

תּוֹדָה

toda

thank you

phrasebook:politeness-01

L22_tav_print_v3
PLACEHOLDER

תּוֹרָה

torah

Torah

lessons:r38

תִּשְׁעָה

tish'a

nine (9)

phrasebook:numbers-09

HOW IT SOUNDS t (with dagesh: t; without dagesh: t). IPA Israeli [t]. Ashkenazi: s without dagesh (Shabbos), t with dagesh. The single most audible Ashkenazi/Sephardi switch (Yit-gadal vs Yis-gadal).

Khaf sofit

kh (final)

PRINT

ך

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

ך

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 1 stroke



Cursive: 1 (draft)

L23_kaf_final_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Key hanging on a hook. The letter's shape: like kaf but the leg drops far below the line. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/kaf-final

placeholder host, not a live site



מֶלֶךְ

melekh
king
lessons:r11



דֶּרֶךְ

derekh
way
lessons:r18



לַמֶּלֶךְ

lamelekh
to the king
lessons:r33

HOW IT SOUNDS kh as in loch (k with dagesh, as in the last word of the Priestly Blessing). IPA Israeli [χ] ([k] with dagesh). Same sounds as kaf; the Priestly Blessing ends one word with ךָ (dagesh) so it is read k. Words below end with this final form.

Mem sofit

m (final)

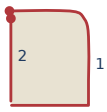
PRINT

ם

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

ם

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 1 (draft)

L24_mem_final_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Sealed box. The letter's shape: a fully closed square. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/mem-final

placeholder host, not a live site



מַיִם

mayim
water
phrasebook:cafe-09



שָׁלוֹם

shalom
hello / goodbye / peace
phrasebook:greetings-01

הַיּוֹם

hayom
today
phrasebook:numbers-20

HOW IT SOUNDS m. IPA Israeli [m]. Same sound as the non-final form. Check with a native speaker or phonetics reference. *(standard value; not in the fetched side-by-side table)* Words below end with this final form.

Nun sofit

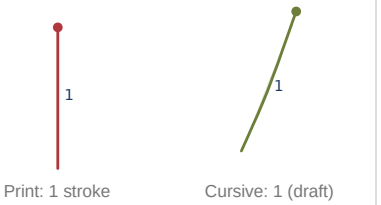
n (final)

PRINT

ן

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 1 stroke

Cursive: 1 (draft)

L25_nun_final_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Nail driven down. The letter's shape: one long straight line dropping below the baseline. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/nun-final

placeholder host, not a live site

L25_nun_final_print_v3
PLACEHOLDER

יַיִן

yayin
wine
phrasebook:cafe-12

L25_nun_final_print_v2
PLACEHOLDER

בֵּן

ben
son
lessons:r12

L25_nun_final_print_v1
PLACEHOLDER

גַּן

gan
garden
lessons:r18

HOW IT SOUNDS n. IPA Israeli [n]. Same sound as the non-final form. Check with a native speaker or phonetics reference. *(standard value; not in the fetched side-by-side table)* Words below end with this final form.

Fe sofit

f (final)

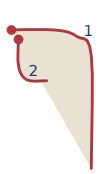
PRINT

ף

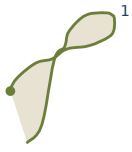
CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)

ף

Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 1 (draft)

L26_pe_final_print_mnemonic
PLACEHOLDER

Find it: Flag on a pole. The letter's shape: pe with its tail dropping below the line. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it:
https://alef.example.org/#/letters/pe-final

placeholder host, not a live site

אֶלֶף

elef

one thousand (1000)

phrasebook:numbers-15

עוֹדֵף

odef

change

lessons:il09

אַף

af

also; nose

lessons:r16

HOW IT SOUNDS f (p with dagesh). IPA Israeli [f] ([p] with dagesh). Same sound as the non-final form. Aspiration of p/t/k compared with English is unsourced (see drills). Words below end with this final form.

Tsadi sofit

ts (final)

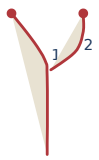
PRINT

ץ

CURSIVE (KTAV YAD)



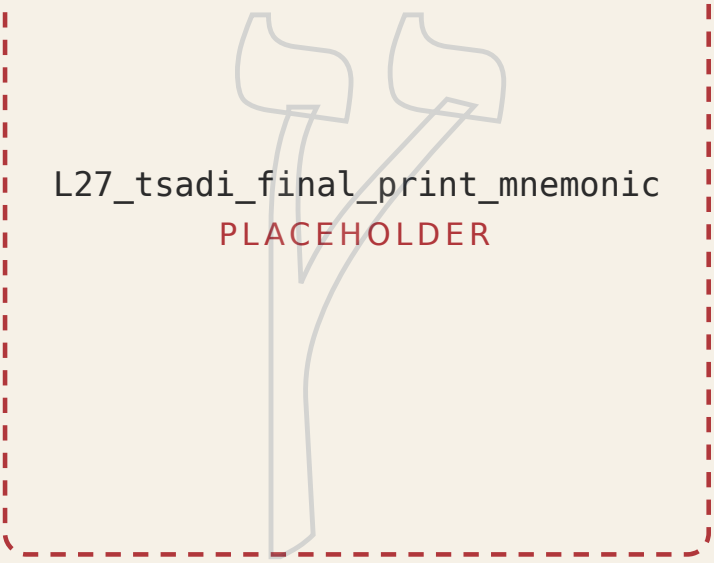
Gveret Levin (OFL font); stroke data below is draft



Print: 2 strokes



Cursive: 1 (draft)



Find it: Tree with a taproot. The letter's shape: tsadi with a long straight descender. (image: AI-image placeholder)

Hear it & trace it: https://alef.example.org/#/letters/tsadi-final

placeholder host, not a live site



אֶרֶץ

eretz

land

lessons:r24

HOW IT SOUNDS ts / tz as in cats. IPA Israeli [ts]. Same sound as the non-final form. Words below end with this final form.

Remember every letter

One card per letter: a shape to see, a sound to say, a silly story that holds both, the look-alike to watch out for, and a word to anchor it. The hook is the memory aid, not the history: the letter-name meanings are real Hebrew words, but the claim that each letter was originally drawn as that object is a popular teaching story. **Draft:** these hooks and the pointed anchor words have not been checked by a Hebrew teacher. The picture on each card is a labelled placeholder until the image run is done; the faint outlined letter is typeset over it as vector. The same 27 cards are on the cut-out flashcard sheets (alef-mnemonic-flashcards-*.pdf).



01

Alef

א

SHAPE

A diagonal stroke with an arm reaching up on the right and a foot at the lower left, like an acrobat mid-handstand.

SOUND

silent letter that carries a vowel (like the tiny pause in 'uh-oh')

STORY

Alef is a mime doing a handstand: every move, zero noise. The vowel under it is the audience, doing all the clapping you can hear.

LOOK-ALIKE

Ayin is the other silent letter, but ayin is a curved cup with a diagonal lash and no crossing diagonal.

ANCHOR WORD

אַבָּא **aba** · dad



02

Bet

ב

SHAPE

A house seen from the side: flat roof, back wall on the right, floor that sticks out past the wall, front door open on the left.

SOUND

b as in 'boy' with a dot inside (bet); v without the dot (vet)

STORY

Bet is a Bungalow with a Ball inside. The dot is the ball, so the house goes B. Take the ball out and it is Vacant: Vet, with a V.

LOOK-ALIKE

Kaf has soft round corners and no sticking-out floor. Bet has sharp corners and its floor pokes out at the back (right).

ANCHOR WORD

בַּיִת **bayit** · house



03

Gimel

ג

SHAPE

An arched back on the right that runs down to a front leg, with a foot kicked out at the lower left.

SOUND

g as in 'go'

STORY

Gimel is a Grumpy camel on the Go: arched hump, and one foot kicked out ahead as he stomps toward the water.

LOOK-ALIKE

Nun is a bent line with a flat base and no kicked-out foot. Gimel has the foot sticking out at the bottom left.

ANCHOR WORD

גָּמָל **gamal** · camel



04

Dalet

ד

SHAPE

A flat board across the top that overhangs on the right, held up by one post.

SOUND

d as in 'door'

STORY

Dalet is a Diving board on a Dock post: a flat plank that sticks out over the water, one post under it. Walk the plank and Dive: D!

LOOK-ALIKE

Resh has a rounded shoulder; dalet has a sharp corner and its board sticks out past the post. Final khaf looks like a resh with a long tail.

ANCHOR WORD

דֶּלֶת **delet** · door



05

He (Hey)

ה

SHAPE

A roof and a right wall, with a short left wall that stops before the roof, leaving a gap.

SOUND

h as in 'hello' (a breath)

STORY

He is a Hut with a Hole in the wall. Lean out of the gap and Holler 'Hey!': the h is the breath that escapes through the hole.

LOOK-ALIKE

Chet is fully closed with no gap. Tav has its leg kicked out at the bottom left. He has a gap between the left leg and the roof.

ANCHOR WORD

הַר **har** · mountain



06

Vav

ו

SHAPE

One plain straight stroke, as tall as the letters beside it, like a nail or a pole.

SOUND

v as in 'van'; also the vowels o and u when it carries them

STORY

Vav is a Vine hanging straight down from the line. Hum 'vvvv' like a vacuum cleaner. It also hooks the next word onto the last: that is why it means 'and'.

LOOK-ALIKE

Zayin has a bar on top. Yod is tiny and floats at the top. Final nun is much longer and drops below the line. Vav is a plain single stroke.

ANCHOR WORD

וֶרֶד **vered** · rose



07

Zayin

ז

SHAPE

A short bar across the top and a straight stem down, like a dagger stabbed into the ground or a tiny T.

SOUND

z as in 'zoo'

STORY

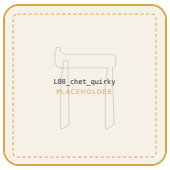
Zayin is a Zapper: a dagger with its guard on top, jabbed into the ground. Swish it and say Zzzap, like a zipper.

LOOK-ALIKE

Vav has no top bar. Final nun is much longer and has no bar. Zayin is short with a bar on the top.

ANCHOR WORD

זָהָב **zahav** · gold



08

Chet

ח

SHAPE

A closed doorway: a roof joining a right leg and a left leg, with no gap.

SOUND

a rough throat 'h', like the ch in 'Chanukah' or Scottish 'loch'

STORY

Chet is a Closed gate with a cat behind it hissing at you: Chhhh! Say it the way you would say 'Chanukah' or 'challah', scraping from the throat.

LOOK-ALIKE

He has a gap in the left wall. Tav has a foot kicked out at the bottom left. Chet is closed all round.

ANCHOR WORD

חָלָב **chalav** · milk



09

Tet

ט

SHAPE

A round-bottomed bowl with the right side curling in at the top, like a teapot with its spout bent inward.

SOUND

t as in 'top'

STORY

Tet is a Teapot with a round Tummy and its spout curled inward, full of Tea. Tov! (good): a Tummy full of Tea is Tov.

LOOK-ALIKE

Mem and samekh are boxy. Tav has straight legs. Tet is one round bowl with a curl at the top.

ANCHOR WORD

טוֹב **tov** · good



10

Yod

י

SHAPE

The smallest letter: a tiny comma that floats at the top of the line.

SOUND

y as in 'yes'

STORY

Yod is a Yo-yo bead hanging at the top of the line, the tiniest letter with the loudest 'Yo!'. Yod for Yad (hand): a hand flicking a yo-yo.

LOOK-ALIKE

Vav is a tall straight stroke from the line to the top. Yod is short and floats near the top only.

ANCHOR WORD

יָד **yad** · hand



11

Kaf

כ

SHAPE

A backwards C: a rounded shape with the opening on the left, like a cupped hand or a spoon bowl.

SOUND

k with a dot inside (kaf); kh like the letter chet, without the dot (khaf)

STORY

Kaf is a Kitchen spoon (kaf means spoon and palm!). With a dot, the Kernel is in the spoon: K. With no dot, it is empty and you breathe on it: Khhh.

LOOK-ALIKE

Bet has sharp corners and a floor that sticks out; kaf is soft and round. Final khaf has a long tail. Pe has a curl inside.

ANCHOR WORD

כֶּלֶב **kelev** · dog



12

Lamed

ל

SHAPE

The only letter that rises above the line: a hook on top, then a bar and a diagonal leg.

SOUND

l as in 'lamp'

STORY

Lamed is a Lamp post with a bent arm that reaches high over the rest of the letters, Lighting the way so everyone can Learn.

LOOK-ALIKE

Nothing else rises above the line, so lamed is rarely confused with another letter.

ANCHOR WORD

לֶחֶם **lechem** · bread



13

Mem

מ

SHAPE

A leaning left stroke and a box on the right whose bottom-left corner is open, like a tent with the door flap open.

SOUND

m as in 'mom'

STORY

Mem is a Mountain tent with its door flap open at the lower left, cosy and Mmm-warm inside. The final mem is the same tent zipped shut all round.

LOOK-ALIKE

Final mem is closed. Samekh is round and closed. Open mem has a gap at the bottom left.

ANCHOR WORD

מַיִם **mayim** · water



14

Nun

נ

SHAPE

A bar on top, a stem on the right and a flat base going left: a figure kneeling and bowed over, facing right.

SOUND

n as in 'no'

STORY

Nun is a Nun kneeling in prayer, bent right over: the top is her bowed head, the stem her back, the base her flat shoes. N for Nun.

LOOK-ALIKE

Gimel has a foot kicked out at the bottom left; nun's base is flat. Kaf is rounder. Final nun is a plain long stick that drops below the line.

ANCHOR WORD

נֵר **ner** · candle



15

Samekh

ס

SHAPE

A closed shape with soft rounded corners, like a ring or a cushion, sitting flat.

SOUND

s as in 'sun'

STORY

Samekh is a Soft cushion with rounded corners: you Sit on it and it Supports you. Sssss goes the air as you sink in.

LOOK-ALIKE

Final mem is a hard box with sharp corners; samekh is round all over. Open mem has a gap.

ANCHOR WORD

סֵפֶר **sefer** · book



16

Ayin

ע

SHAPE

A curved cup on the right and a leaning stroke on the left, like a V-shaped eyelid with a lash.

SOUND

silent in most Israeli speech, like alef; a deep throat sound in some traditions

STORY

Ayin is an Eye winking silently: it sees everything and says nothing. All you hear is the vowel beneath, the same as alef.

LOOK-ALIKE

Tsadi has a flat base and a fork shape. Alef is the other silent letter but has a crossing diagonal. Ayin sweeps in one curve.

ANCHOR WORD

עַיִן **ayin** · eye



17

Pe

פ

SHAPE

A rounded shape like kaf, with a curl tucked inside at the top left like a tongue behind the lips.

SOUND

p as in 'pop' with a dot inside (pe); f without the dot (fe)

STORY

Pe is a mouth pursed to Pop a bubble: with the dot it goes Pop, P! Without the dot the lips go loose and the air Fluffs out: Ffff, F.

LOOK-ALIKE

Kaf has no curl inside. Final fe has a long tail below the line. Pe has the curl tucked inside.

ANCHOR WORD

פֶּה **peh** · mouth



18

Tsadi

צ

SHAPE

A Y-shaped fork on top that slants down into a flat base, like a kneeling person with raised arms.

SOUND

ts as in 'pizza'

STORY

Tsadi is a Tsetse fly with its wings up in a Y, perched on a slice of pizza: ts-ts-ts, the 'ts' of pizza, cats and nuts.

LOOK-ALIKE

Ayin has no flat base and sweeps in one curve. Final tsadi stands tall with a long stem. Tsadi's second stroke comes from the top right.

ANCHOR WORD

צִפּוֹר **tsipor** · bird



19

Qof

ק

SHAPE

Like kaf with a long left leg that drops below the line.

SOUND

k as in 'kite' (same as kaf)

STORY

Qof is a Kooky monkey hanging down from a branch: the leg that dangles below the line is his tail. K for Kof, K for Kooky.

LOOK-ALIKE

Kaf stays on the line and has no leg below. Qof's leg hangs below the line.

ANCHOR WORD

קוֹף **kof** · monkey



20

Resh

ר

SHAPE

A flat top and a smoothly curved right shoulder with no corner, like a head seen from the side.

SOUND

r (from the back of the throat in Israeli speech)

STORY

Resh is a Round head (rosh) from the side: a smooth shoulder with no corner. Rrrr, a growl from the back of the throat.

LOOK-ALIKE

Dalet has a sharp corner at top right and its bar sticks out. Resh is rounded. Final khaf is a resh with a very long tail.

ANCHOR WORD

רֹאשׁ **rosh** · head



21

Shin

ש

SHAPE

Three prongs rising from a curved base, like three candle flames or a trident.

SOUND

sh as in 'shoe' with the dot on the right (shin); s as in 'sun' with the dot on the left (sin)

STORY

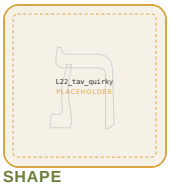
Shin is three flames on a birthday cake with a finger to the lips: Shhhh! The dot at the top right keeps it shh. A dot on the left makes it Sin: sinister means 'left'.

LOOK-ALIKE

Nothing common: only shin has three prongs. Tsadi is the closest in cursive.

ANCHOR WORD

שָׁלוֹם **shalom** · peace, hello



22

Tav

ת

SHAPE

A roof with a right leg and a short left leg kicked out at the bottom, like he but with a foot.

SOUND

t as in 'top' (s in the Ashkenazi 'Shabbos')

STORY

Tav is a Table with a Toe: the right leg is straight, and the left leg has a toe tapping in thanks. Toda! (thank you)

LOOK-ALIKE

Chet is closed with no foot. He has a gap in the left wall. Tav has its foot at the bottom left.

ANCHOR WORD

תּוֹדָה **toda** · thank you



23

Final Khaf

ך

SHAPE
A bar and a rounded shoulder with a long straight tail dropping below the line.
SOUND
kh (the chet sound), only at the end of a word
STORY
Final khaf is a King's cloak dragging on the floor behind him. The word ends and the cloak trails: melekh, with a throaty kh.
LOOK-ALIKE
Dalet and resh stay on the line. Final nun has no top bar. Final khaf has a bar, a rounded shoulder and a tail.
ANCHOR WORD

מֶלֶךְ **melekh** · king



24

Final Mem

ם

SHAPE
A closed box with sharp corners.
SOUND
m, only at the end of a word
STORY
Final mem is the Mountain tent zipped shut: the word is over, nothing can get in. Yam, the sea outside, ends in a closed box.
LOOK-ALIKE
Samekh is a soft round ring. Open mem has a gap at the bottom left. Final mem is closed and square.
ANCHOR WORD

יָם **yam** · sea



25

Final Nun

ן

SHAPE
One straight stroke that drops below the line, like a nail or a pole.
SOUND
n, only at the end of a word
STORY
Final nun is the Nun standing up straight at last, her long coat reaching below the line. Gan, a garden, ends in a straight pole.
LOOK-ALIKE
Vav is shorter and stays on the line. Final khaf has a bar and a shoulder. Final nun is a plain long stick.
ANCHOR WORD

גַּן **gan** · garden, kindergarten



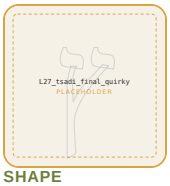
26

Final Fe

ף

SHAPE
The pe shape with its curl inside and a long right stem that drops below the line.
SOUND
f, only at the end of a word
STORY
Final fe is a mouth with the tongue lolling out below the line to blow Fffff at the end of the word, the way you blow a feather off a spoon (kaf).
LOOK-ALIKE
Final tsadi forks like a Y on top; final fe has the curl and a round top. Pe stays on the line.
ANCHOR WORD

כַּף **kaf** · spoon, palm



27

Final Tsadi

ץ

SHAPE
A Y-shaped fork on top and one long straight stem dropping below the line.
SOUND
ts, only at the end of a word
STORY
Final tsadi is a Tree: Y-shaped branches on top and a long trunk down into the land (eretz). The tree rustles ts at the end of the word.
LOOK-ALIKE
Final fe has a round top and a curl. Final nun has no fork. Final tsadi forks like a Y.
ANCHOR WORD

אֶרֶץ **eretz** · land, country

The vowels and marks

Hebrew vowels are dots and dashes around the letter, shown here on a bet (or a vav for the two vav-vowels). Modern Israeli Hebrew has five vowel sounds, so several signs share one sound; the traditions differ more. From data/pronunciation/niqqud.json.



Kamatz (kamatz gadol) קָמָץ

below (T-shaped mark under the letter)

Example: אָב father

Israeli [a] a as in father (short, no glide)
Sephardi [a(ː)] a as in father
Ashkenazi [ɔ] aw as in saw (Barukh -> Bawrukh)

Variants: בָה kamatz + silent he (or alef); same sound as kamatz · בׇ Has its own Unicode glyph U+05C7 but most print uses the ordinary kamatz.

In Ashkenazi the alternative values are [u] in open syllables (southern dialects) and [ʌ] (Lithuanian). *(English approximation not source-verified)*



Patach פַּתַח

below (horizontal line)

Example: בַּיִת house (bayit)

Israeli [a] a as in father
Sephardi [a] a as in father
Ashkenazi [a] a as in father

A patach under a final ע ,ח or ה-with-mappiq is a furtive patach and is read BEFORE the letter (נַח = [no.ax]). *(English approximation not source-verified)*



Tzere צֵירֵי

below (two horizontal dots)

Example: בֵּן son (ben)

Israeli [ɛ] e as in bed (a few words and speakers say ei as in they)
Sephardi [e(ː)] e as in bed
Ashkenazi [ej] ei as in they (Polish usage is often like eye)

Variants: בֵי tzere + yod; commonly romanised ei

Pealim: Israeli tzere may be [ei] in some cases, not for all speakers. Ashkenazi [aj] is the Polish variant. *(English approximation not source-verified)*



Segol סֶגוֹל

below (three dots in a triangle)

Example: סֵפֶר book (sefer)

Israeli [ɛ] e as in bed
Sephardi [e] e as in bed
Ashkenazi [e] e as in bed (stressed syllables in Polish/Ukrainian usage: ei)

Israeli tzere and segol sound the same; the sign distinction survives only in the spelling. *(English approximation not source-verified)*



Chirik חִירִיק

below (single dot)

Example: אִמָּא mother (ima)

Israeli [i] i as in machine (short)
Sephardi [i] i as in machine
Ashkenazi [i] i as in machine

Variants: בִי chirik + yod; same sound

Israeli writing usually adds a yod (chirik malei) to disambiguate; same sound. *(English approximation not source-verified)*



Cholam חוֹלָם

above-left of the letter (chaser) or over a vav (malei)

Example: שָׁלוֹם peace (shalom)

Israeli [ɒ] o as in for (no glide)
Sephardi [o(ː)] o as in home
Ashkenazi [o] o as in home (southern German / many American Ashkenazim); oy as in oy vey (Polish/Galician, Chasidic); ow (northern German)

Variants: בֹ cholam without vav: the dot sits above-left of the letter · בוֹ cholam on a vav (vav is a vowel letter here); same sound

Ashkenazi values by sub-dialect: [oj] Polish/Galician, [au] N. German, [ej] Lithuanian, [øi] Hungarian, [o] S. German. *(English approximation not source-verified)*



Kubutz קֻבּוּץ

below (three diagonal dots)

Example: סֻכָּה sukkah (booth)

Israeli [u] oo as in boot (short)
Sephardi [u] oo as in boot
Ashkenazi [u] oo as in boot; occasionally as in put

Hungarian/Oberlander Ashkenazi [y]; occasional [ʊ]. Same sound as shuruk. *(English approximation not source-verified)*



Shuruk שׁוּרוּק

a dot inside a vav (the vav is a vowel letter)

Example: סוּס horse (sus)

Israeli [u] oo as in boot
Sephardi [u] oo as in boot
Ashkenazi [u] oo as in boot

The shared id is shuruk; the shape is a vav with a dagesh dot (U+05D5 U+05BC) after a consonant. *(English approximation not source-verified)*

Shva שְׁוָא



below (two vertical dots)

Example: שְׁמַע hear (Shema)

Israeli [ę] or ∅ (no vowel) e as in begin, or silent
Sephardi [ɛ]~[ę] when vocal, ∅ when silent e as in bed when vocal; silent otherwise
Ashkenazi ∅ colloquially (zman); [e]/[ə] when read strictly in liturgy often dropped (zman); short uh/e when read strictly in prayer

js. Modern Israelis often drop or insert the [e] on phonological grounds, not by the historical rules; no corpus measurement was found. *(English approximation not source-verified)*

Chataf patach חֲטַף פַּתַח



below (shva + patach)

Example: חֲבֵרָה company / female friend (chavera)

Israeli [a] very short a as in father
Sephardi [a] very short a
Ashkenazi [a] very short a

Reduced vowels appear mostly under guttural letters. *(English approximation not source-verified)*

Chataf segol חֲטַף סֶגוֹל



below (shva + segol)

Example: אֱמֶת truth (emet)

Israeli [ę] very short e as in bed
Sephardi [e] very short e
Ashkenazi [e] very short e

Short reduced e. *(English approximation not source-verified)*

Chataf kamatz חֲטַף קָמָץ



below (shva + kamatz)

Example: צָהֳרַיִם noon (tsohorayim)

Israeli [o̧] very short o as in for
Sephardi [ɔ] very short o
Ashkenazi [ɔ] very short aw/o

Not to be confused with kamatz katan. *(English approximation not source-verified)*

Dagesh דָּגֵשׁ



inside the letter (a dot)

Example: שַׁבָּת Shabbat

Israeli hardens bet/kaf/pe to [b][k][p]; gemination absent no sound of its own; makes b, k, p instead of v, kh, f
Sephardi hardens bet/kaf/pe to [b][k][p]; (gemination not covered by the sources fetched) same
Ashkenazi hardens bet/kaf/pe to [b][k][p]; (gemination not covered by the sources fetched) same; also makes tav t instead of s

Variants: בּ hardens begadkefat letters (bet, gimel, dalet, kaf, pe, tav); only bet/kaf/pe change sound in Israeli Hebrew · שּׁ doubling; not heard in Israeli Hebrew · הּ dagesh in a final he: the he is a real [h]

Two things share one sign: dagesh kal (begadkefat hardening) and dagesh chazak (doubling). *(English approximation not source-verified)*

Shin dot נקודת שין



above the right branch of the letter

Example: שָׁלוֹם peace (shalom)

Israeli [ʃ] sh as in shoe
Sephardi [ʃ] sh as in shoe
Ashkenazi [ʃ] sh as in shoe

The dot is written over the right (first) branch. *(English approximation not source-verified)*

Sin dot נקודת שין שמאלית



above the left (third) branch of the letter

Example: יִשְׂרָאֵל Israel (Yisrael)

Israeli [s] s as in sun
Sephardi [s] s as in sun
Ashkenazi [s] s as in sun

Lithuanian Ashkenazi historically merged shin and sin as [s] (historical, not current). *(English approximation not source-verified)*

Reading practice: syllables

Say each syllable aloud. Rows are consonants, columns are vowel signs (Israeli values).

	אַ	אָ	אֵ	אֶ	אִ	אֹ	אֻ
m	מַ ma	מָ ma	מֵ me	מֶ me	מִ mi	מֹ mo	מֻ mu
l	לַ la	לָ la	לֵ le	לֶ le	לִ li	לֹ lo	לֻ lu
sh	שַׁ sha	שָׁ sha	שֵׁ she	שֶׁ she	שִׁ shi	שֹׁ sho	שֻׁ shu
r	רַ ra	רָ ra	רֵ re	רֶ re	רִ ri	רֹ ro	רֻ ru
b	בַּ ba	בָּ ba	בֵּ be	בֶּ be	בִּ bi	בֹּ bo	בֻּ bu
d	דַ da	דָ da	דֵ de	דֶ de	דִ di	דֹ do	דֻ du

Generated from code points only.

Reading practice: words

72 short words from the reading-track lessons (data/curriculum/lessons.json), in lesson order, so the first ones use only the letters and vowels taught first. Transliteration comes from the phrasebook where it has the word; entries marked * are machine-generated by the app's transliterator (Israeli, siddur style) and have not been checked by a native speaker.

שָׁב **shav*** he returned	שַׁבָּת **shabat*** Sabbath	בַּת **bat*** daughter	שָׁלוֹם **shalom** peace; hello
לוֹ **lo*** to him	בִּי **bi*** in me	לִי **li*** to me	אַבָּא **aba*** dad
בָּא **ba*** he came	הָיָה **hayah*** he was	לֹא **lo** no; not	אֵל **el*** God
בֵּית **beit*** house of	לֵב **lev*** heart	שִׁיר **shir*** song	אִמָּא **ima*** mom
רֹאשׁ **rosh*** head	רָם **ram*** high	כִּי **ki*** because	לְךָ **lakh*** to you
אַתָּה **atah*** you (m.)	אֶת **et*** (object marker)	מֶלֶךְ **melekh*** king	בֵּן **ben*** son
שָׁנָה **shanah*** year	אֲנִי **ani*** I	אָמֵן **amen*** amen	שׁוּב **shuv*** again; return!
כֻּלָּם **kulam*** all of them	בְּרָכָה **berakhah*** blessing	לְךָ **lekha*** to you	וְאֲנִי **ve'ani*** and I
יְהוָה **adonai*** the Name (read aloud as Adonai)	פֶּה **peh*** mouth	אַף **af*** also; nose	פָּנָיו **panav*** His face

חַי **chai*** alive	חָכָם **chakham*** wise	רוּחַ **rucha*** spirit; wind	אֶחָד **echad** one
גָּדוֹל **gadol*** big	גַּן **gan*** garden	דֶּרֶךְ **derekh*** way	שְׁמַע **shema*** hear!
עַם **am*** people	עוֹלָם **olam*** world; forever	סֵפֶר **sefer*** book	שִׂמְחָה **simchah*** joy
אֱלֹהִים **elohim*** God	אֱמֶת **emet*** truth	אֲנִי **ani*** I	אֲדֹנָי **adonai*** my Lord (read in place of the Name)
אֳנִיָּה **oniyah*** ship	זֶה **zeh*** this	טוֹב **tov** good	זָהָב **zahav*** gold
טַל **tal*** dew	צֶדֶק **tzedek*** justice	אֶרֶץ **eretz*** land	קוֹל **kol*** voice
קָדוֹשׁ **kadosh*** holy	צְדָקָה **tzedakah*** charity; justice	יָאֵר **ya'er*** may He shine	אֵלֶיךָ **elekha*** toward you
יִשָּׂא **yisa*** may He lift	וְיָשֵׂם **veyasem*** and grant	בָּרוּךְ **barukh*** blessed	הָעוֹלָם **ha'olam*** the world
מִשְׁפָּט **mishpat*** justice	וּבְכָל **uvekhal*** and with all	כָּתַב **katav*** he wrote	שְׁמֵהּ **shemeh*** His name (Aramaic)

The Priestly Blessing, word by word

Hebrew	Modern Israeli	Literal
יְבָרֶכְךָ	yevarekh'kha	may-he-bless-you
וְיִשְׁמְרֶךָ	veyishmerekha	and-may-he-keep-you
יָאֵר	ya'er	may-he-shine
פָּנָיו	panav	his-face
אֵלֶיךָ	elekha	toward-you
וִיחֻנֶּךָּ	vichuneka	and-may-he-be-gracious-to-you
יִשָּׂא	yisa	may-he-lift
וְיָשֵׂם	veyasem	and-may-he-set
לְךָ	lekha	for-you
שָׁלוֹם	shalom	peace

The divine name (three occurrences, spoken “Adonai”) is omitted from this table. Words and glosses come from a research note and are **not yet verified by a Hebrew teacher**.

Prayers and verses: Shema, Blessing and daily words

70 texts from data/corpus/registry.json in 5 chapters (Shema, Blessing and daily words; The Torah service; The Amidah, Kedushah and closing prayers; Shabbat, Psalms and the table; Hanukkah), each text with its own code. Every text matches its cited source by machine comparison; **none has been proofread by a Hebrew educator**, and none was typed from memory. The divine name appears as written in the sources and is read “Adonai”. Some texts overlap (the Shema appears alone, within the V’ahavta and in the combined reading). Texts differ by community: each footer names the text tradition (nusach) of its source.

The texts that come first in a Hebrew-reading life: the Shema, the Priestly Blessing line by line, the V’ahavta, and the short blessings said at home.

Shema Yisrael Deuteronomy 6:4

שְׁמַע יִשְׂרָאֵל יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ יְהוָה אֶחָד׃

HEAR, O ISRAEL: THE LORD OUR GOD, THE LORD IS ONE.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/shema-1

Baruch shem (said after Shema line) Siddur: Baruch shem kevod malchuto

בָּרוּךְ שֵׁם כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד׃

Blessed is the name of the glory of his kingship for ever and ever.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Blessings of the Shema, Shema · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/shema-2

Shema and V'ahavta (Deut 6:4-9) Deuteronomy 6:4-9

שְׁמַע יִשְׂרָאֵל יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ יְהוָה אֶחָד׃
וְאָהַבְתָּ אֵת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ בְּכָל־לְבָבְךָ וּבְכָל־נַפְשְׁךָ וּבְכָל־מְאֹדֶךָ׃
וְהָיוּ הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה אֲשֶׁר אָנֹכִי מְצַוְּךָ הַיּוֹם עַל־לְבָבֶךָ׃
וְשִׁנַּנְתָּם לְבָנֶיךָ וְדִבַּרְתָּ בָּם בְּשִׁבְתְּךָ בְּבֵיתֶךָ וּבְלֶכְתְּךָ בַדֶּרֶךְ וּבְשָׁכְבְּךָ וּבְקוּמֶךָ׃
וּקְשַׁרְתָּם לְאוֹת עַל־יָדֶךָ וְהָיוּ לְטֹטָפֹת בֵּין עֵינֶיךָ׃
וּכְתַבְתָּם עַל־מְזוּזוֹת בֵּיתֶךָ וּבִשְׁעָרֶיךָ׃

HEAR, O ISRAEL: THE LORD OUR GOD, THE LORD IS ONE. And thou shalt love the LORD thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy might. And these words, which I command thee this day, shall be upon thy heart; and thou shalt teach them diligently unto thy children, and shalt talk of them when thou sittest in thy house, and when thou walkest by the way, and when thou liest down, and when thou risest up. And thou shalt bind them for a sign upon thy hand, and they shall be for frontlets between thine eyes. And thou shalt write them upon the door-posts of thy house, and upon thy gates.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/shema-vahavta

V'ahavta, verse 1 Deuteronomy 6:5

וְאָהַבְתָּ אֵת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ בְּכָל־לְבָבְךָ וּבְכָל־נַפְשְׁךָ וּבְכָל־מְאֹדֶךָ׃

And thou shalt love the LORD thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy might.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/vahavta-1

V'ahavta, verses 2-3 Deuteronomy 6:6-7

וְהָיוּ הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה אֲשֶׁר אָנֹכִי מְצַוְּךָ הַיּוֹם עַל־לְבָבֶךָ׃

וְשִׁנַּנְתָּם לְבָנֶיךָ וְדִבַּרְתָּ בָּם בְּשִׁבְתְּךָ בְּבֵיתֶךָ וּבְלֶכְתְּךָ בַדֶּרֶךְ וּבְשָׁכְבְּךָ וּבְקוּמֶךָ׃

And these words, which I command thee this day, shall be upon thy heart; and thou shalt teach them diligently unto thy children, and shalt talk of them when thou sittest in thy house, and when thou walkest by the way, and when thou liest down, and when thou risest up.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/vahavta-2

V'ahavta Deuteronomy 6:5-9

וְאָהַבְתָּ אֵת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ בְּכָל־לְבָבְךָ וּבְכָל־נַפְשְׁךָ וּבְכָל־מְאֹדֶךָ׃

וְהָיוּ הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה אֲשֶׁר אָנֹכִי מְצַוְּךָ הַיּוֹם עַל־לְבָבֶךָ׃

וְשִׁנַּנְתָּם לְבָנֶיךָ וְדִבַּרְתָּ בָּם בְּשִׁבְתְּךָ בְּבֵיתֶךָ וּבְלֶכְתְּךָ בַדֶּרֶךְ וּבְשָׁכְבְּךָ וּבְקוּמֶךָ׃

וּקְשַׁרְתָּם לְאוֹת עַל־יָדֶךָ וְהָיוּ לְטֹטָפֹת בֵּין עֵינֶיךָ׃

וּכְתַבְתָּם עַל־מְזוּזוֹת בֵּיתֶךָ וּבִשְׁעָרֶיךָ׃

And thou shalt love the LORD thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy might. And these words, which I command thee this day, shall be upon thy heart; and thou shalt teach them diligently unto thy children, and shalt talk of them when thou sittest in thy house, and when thou walkest by the way, and when thou liest down, and when thou risest up. And thou shalt bind them for a sign upon thy hand, and they shall be for frontlets between thine eyes. And thou shalt write them upon the door-posts of thy house, and upon thy gates.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/vahavta-full

Priestly Blessing, line 1 Numbers 6:24

יְבָרֶכְךָ יְהוָה וְיִשְׁמְרֶךָ׃

The LORD bless thee, and keep thee;

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/bless-priestly-1

Priestly Blessing, line 2 Numbers 6:25

יָאֵר יְהוָה פָּנָיו אֵלֶיךָ וִיחֻנֶּךָּ׃

The LORD make His face to shine upon thee, and be gracious unto thee;

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/bless-priestly-2

Priestly Blessing, line 3 Numbers 6:26

יִשָּׂא יְהוָה פָּנָיו אֵלֶיךָ וְיָשֵׂם לְךָ שָׁלוֹם׃

The LORD lift up His countenance upon thee, and give thee peace.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/bless-priestly-3

El na refa na lah (Moses' prayer for healing) Numbers 12:13 (second half)

אֵל נָא רְפָא נָא לָהּ׃

God, please, heal her, please.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/num-12-13

Blessing formula (Baruch atah Adonai Eloheinu Melech ha'olam) Siddur: blessing formula

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world,

Hebrew: Shaliehsaboo Edition via Sefaria: Siddur Edot HaMizrach, Shabbat Evening, First Meal · licence: CC0. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/bless-formula-1

HaMotzi (blessing over bread) Siddur: HaMotzi

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם הַמּוֹצִיא לֶחֶם מִן הָאָרֶץ׃

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world, who brings forth bread from the earth.

Hebrew: Shaliehsaboo Edition via Sefaria: Siddur Edot HaMizrach, Shabbat Evening, First Meal · licence: CC0. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Edot HaMizrach (Shaliehsaboo edition) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/hamotzi

Modeh Ani (on waking) Siddur: Modeh Ani

מוֹדֶה אֲנִי לְפָנֶיךָ מֶלֶךְ חַי וְקַיָּם שֶׁהֶחֱזַרְתָּ בִּי נִשְׁמָתִי בְּחֶמְלָה רַבָּה אֱמוּנָתֶךָ׃

I give thanks before you, living and enduring king, that you have returned my soul to me in mercy; great is your faithfulness.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Preparatory Prayers, Modeh Ani · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/modeh-ani-1

Shehecheyanu (first-time and festival blessing) Siddur: Shehecheyanu

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם שֶׁהֶחֱיָינוּ וְקִיְּמָנוּ וְהִגִּיעָנוּ לַזְּמַן הַזֶּה׃

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world, who has kept us alive, sustained us, and brought us to this time.

Hebrew: Shaliehsaboo Edition via Sefaria: Siddur Edot HaMizrach, Hanukkah, Menorah Lighting · licence: CC0. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Edot HaMizrach (Shaliehsaboo edition) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/shehecheyanu

Mah Tovu (first verse) Numbers 24:5

מַה־טֹּבוּ אֹהָלֶיךָ יַעֲקֹב מִשְׁכְּנֹתֶיךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל׃

How goodly are thy tents, O Jacob, Thy dwellings, O Israel!

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/mah-tovu-1

Mi Chamocha Exodus 15:11

מִי־כָמֹכָה בָּאֵלִם יְהוָה מִי כָּמֹכָה נֶאְדָּר בַּקֹּדֶשׁ נוֹרָא תְהִלֹּת עֹשֵׂה פֶלֶא׃

Who is like unto Thee, O LORD, among the mighty? Who is like unto Thee, glorious in holiness, Fearful in praises, doing wonders?

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/mi-chamocha-1

The Torah service

Everything said when the ark is opened, the Torah is carried, read and returned, plus the haftarah blessings, the blessing after surviving danger and the opening of the Mi sheberach. Practice-first: the short verses come before the long Aramaic and haftarah texts. Customs and wording vary by community; each footer says whose text it is.

Ein Kamocha (opening line of the Torah-ark prayer) Psalm 86:8

אֵין־כָּמוֹךָ בָּאֱלֹהִים אֲדֹנָי וְאֵין כְּמַעֲשֶׂיךָ׃

There is none like unto Thee among the gods, O Lord, And there are no works like Thine.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/ein-kamocha

Malchutcha (second line of Ein Kamocha) Psalm 145:13

מַלְכוּתְךָ מַלְכוּת כָּל־עֹלָמִים וּמֶמְשֶׁלְתְּךָ בְּכָל־דּוֹר וָדוֹר׃

Thy kingdom is a kingdom for all ages, And Thy dominion endureth throughout all generations.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/malchutcha

Adonai oz l'amo yiten (closing line of Ein Kamocha) Psalm 29:11

יְהוָה עֹז לְעַמּוֹ יִתֵּן יְהוָה יְבָרֵךְ אֶת־עַמּוֹ בַשָּׁלוֹם׃

The LORD will give strength unto His people; The LORD will bless his people with peace.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/adonai-oz

Vayehi binsoa ha-aron (opening the ark) Siddur: Vayehi binsoa (Numbers 10:35, Isaiah 2:3, blessing)

וַיְהִי בִּנְסֹעַ הָאָרֹן וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה קוּמָה יְהוָה וְיָפֻצוּ אֹיְבֶיךָ וְיָנֻסוּ מְשַׂנְאֶיךָ מִפָּנֶיךָ׃ כִּי מִצִּיּוֹן תֵּצֵא תוֹרָה וּדְבַר יְהוָה מִירוּשָׁלָם׃ בָּרוּךְ שֶׁנָּתַן תּוֹרָה לְעַמּוֹ יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּקְדֻשָּׁתוֹ׃

And it was, when the ark set out, Moses said: Arise, LORD, and let your enemies be scattered, and let those who hate you flee before you. For from Zion will go forth Torah, and the word of the LORD from Jerusalem. Blessed is the one who gave the Torah to his people Israel in his holiness.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Torah Reading, Removing the Torah from Ark, Vayehi Binsoa · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: transcribed-needs-check · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/vayehi-binsoa

Berich shmei (Aramaic prayer when the ark is opened) Siddur: Berich shmei (Zohar, Vayakhel)

בְּרִיךְ שְׁמֵהּ דְּמָרֵא עָלְמָא בְּרִיךְ כְּתָרָךְ וְאַתְרָךְ יְהֵא רְעוּתָךְ עִם עַמָּךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל לְעָלַם וּפָרְקַן יְמִינָךְ אַחֲזֵי לְעַמָּךְ בְּבֵית מַקְדְּשָׁךְ
וּלְאַמְטוּיֵי לָנָא מִטּוּב נְהוֹרָךְ וּלְקַבֵּל צְלוֹתָנָא בְּרַחֲמִין יְהֵא רַעֲוָא קֳדָמָךְ דְּתוֹרִיךְ לָן חַיִּין בְּטִיבוּ וְלֶהֱוֵי אֲנָא פְּקִידָא בְּגוֹ צַדִּיקַיָּא
לְמִרְחַם עָלַי וּלְמִנְטַר יָתִי וְיָת־כָּל־דִּי־לִי וְדִי־לְעַמָּךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל אַנְתְּ הוּא זָן לְכֹלָּא וּמְפַרְנֵס לְכֹלָּא אַנְתְּ הוּא שַׁלִּיט עַל־כֹּלָּא אַנְתְּ הוּא
דְּשַׁלִּיט עַל־מַלְכַיָּא וּמַלְכוּתָא דִּילָךְ הִיא אֲנָא עַבְדָּא דְּקֻדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא דְּסָגִידְנָא קַמֵּהּ וּמְקַמֵּי דִּיקָר אוֹרַיְתֵהּ בְּכָל־עִדָּן וְעִדָּן לָא
עַל־אֱנָשׁ רָחִיצְנָא וְלָא עַל־בַּר־אֱלָהִין סָמִיכְנָא אֶלָּא בֵּאלָהָא דִּשְׁמַיָּא דְּהוּא אֱלָהָא קְשׁוֹט וְאוֹרַיְתֵהּ קְשׁוֹט וּנְבִיאוֹהִי קְשׁוֹט
וּמַסְגֵּא לְמֶעְבַּד טָבְוָן וּקְשׁוֹט בֵּהּ אֲנָא רָחִיץ וְלִשְׁמֵהּ קַדִּישָׁא יַקִּירָא אֲנָא אֵמַר תֻּשְׁבְּחָן יְהֵא רַעֲוָא קֳדָמָךְ דְּתִפְתַּח לִבָּאי
בְּאוֹרַיְתָא וְתַשְׁלִים מִשְׁאֲלִין דְּלִבָּאי וְלִבָּא דְכָל־עַמָּךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל לְטָב וּלְחַיִּין וְלִשְׁלָם:

Blessed is the name of the Master of the world; blessed is your crown and your place. May your good will be with your people Israel for ever; show your people the redemption of your right hand in your Temple, bring us of the goodness of your light, and accept our prayer in mercy. May it be your will to lengthen our life in goodness, and let me be counted among the righteous, so that you have mercy on me and guard me and all that is mine and your people Israel's. You feed and sustain all; you rule over all; you rule over kings, and the kingdom is yours. I am a servant of the Holy One, blessed be he, before whom and before whose glorious Torah I bow at every time. Not in any person do I trust, and not on any angel do I rely, but on the God of heaven, who is the God of truth, whose Torah is truth and whose prophets are truth, and who abounds in deeds of goodness and truth. In him I trust, and to his holy and glorious name I utter praises. May it be your will to open my heart to Torah, to fulfil the requests of my heart and the heart of all your people Israel, for good, for life and for peace.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Torah Reading, Removing the Torah from Ark, Berich Shmei · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/brich-shmei

Gadlu l'Adonai iti (leader invites the congregation to magnify) Psalm 34:4

גַּדְּלוּ לַיהוָה אִתִּי וּנְרוֹמְמָה שְׁמוֹ יַחְדָּו׃

O magnify the LORD with me, And let us exalt His name together.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/gadlu

Lecha Adonai hagedulah (carrying the Torah around) Siddur: Lecha Adonai hagedulah (1 Chronicles 29:11, Psalm 99:5, 99:9)

לְךָ יְהוָה הַגְּדֻלָּה וְהַגְּבוּרָה וְהַתִּפְאֶרֶת וְהַנֵּצַח וְהַהוֹד כִּי כֹל בַּשָּׁמַיִם וּבָאָרֶץ לְךָ יְהוָה הַמַּמְלָכָה וְהַמִּתְנַשֵּׂא
לְכֹל לְרֹאשׁ׃ רוֹמְמוּ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ וְהִשְׁתַּחֲווּ לַהֲדֹם רַגְלָיו קָדוֹשׁ הוּא׃ רוֹמְמוּ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ וְהִשְׁתַּחֲווּ לְהַר
קָדְשׁוֹ כִּי קָדוֹשׁ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ׃

Yours, LORD, are the greatness and the might and the splendour and the victory and the majesty, for everything in heaven and on earth is yours. Yours, LORD, is the kingdom, and you are exalted as head over all. Exalt the LORD our God and bow at his footstool: he is holy. Exalt the LORD our God and bow at his holy mountain, for the LORD our God is holy.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Torah Reading, Removing the Torah from Ark, Lekha Hashem · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/lecha-hashem

V'zot haTorah (said when the Torah is lifted) Siddur: V'zot haTorah (Deuteronomy 4:44, Numbers 9:23)

וְזֹאת הַתּוֹרָה אֲשֶׁר שָׂם מֹשֶׁה לִפְנֵי בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל פִּי יְהוָה בְּיַד מֹשֶׁה׃

This is the Torah that Moses set before the children of Israel, by the word of the LORD, by the hand of Moses.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Torah Reading, Reading from Sefer, Raising the Torah · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: transcribed-needs-check · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/vezot-hatorah

Torah blessing (before reading/study) Siddur: Torah blessing (asher bachar banu)

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם אֲשֶׁר בָּחַר בָּנוּ מִכָּל־הָעַמִּים וְנָתַן לָנוּ אֶת־תּוֹרָתוֹ

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה נוֹתֵן הַתּוֹרָה׃

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world, who chose us from all the peoples and gave us his Torah. Blessed are you, LORD, giver of the Torah.

Hebrew: Shaliehsaboo Edition via Sefaria: Siddur Edot HaMizrach, Preparatory Prayers, Torah Blessings · licence: CC0. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Edot HaMizrach (Shaliehsaboo edition) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/torah-bless-1

Barchu (call to the Torah blessing) Siddur: Barchu before the Torah reading

בָּרְכוּ אֶת יְהוָה הַמְבֹרָךְ׃

בָּרוּךְ יְהוָה הַמְבֹרָךְ לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד׃

Bless the LORD, the blessed one. Blessed is the LORD, the blessed one, for ever and ever.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Torah Reading, Reading from Sefer, Birkat HaTorah · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/torah-barchu

Torah blessing (after reading) Siddur: Torah blessing after the reading

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם אֲשֶׁר נָתַן לָנוּ תּוֹרַת אֱמֶת וְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם נָטַע בְּתוֹכֵנוּ׃

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה נוֹתֵן הַתּוֹרָה׃

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world, who gave us a Torah of truth and planted eternal life in our midst. Blessed are you, LORD, giver of the Torah.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Torah Reading, Reading from Sefer, Birkat HaTorah · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/torah-bless-2

Haftarah blessings before the reading Siddur: Haftarah, blessings before

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם אֲשֶׁר בָּחַר בִּנְבִיאִים טוֹבִים וְרָצָה בְדִבְרֵיהֶם הַנֶּאֱמָרִים בֶּאֱמֶת בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה הַבּוֹחֵר בַּתּוֹרָה וּבְמֹשֶׁה עַבְדּוֹ וּבְיִשְׂרָאֵל עַמּוֹ וּבִנְבִיאֵי הָאֱמֶת וְהַצֶּדֶק:

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world, who chose good prophets and was pleased with their words, which were spoken in truth. Blessed are you, LORD, who chooses the Torah, and Moses his servant, and Israel his people, and prophets of truth and righteousness.

Hebrew: Shaliehsaboo Edition via Sefaria: Siddur Edot HaMizrach, Shabbat Shacharit, Haftarah · licence: CC0. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Edot HaMizrach (Shaliehsaboo edition) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/haftarah-before

Haftarah blessings after the reading (Shabbat) Siddur: Haftarah, blessings after (Shabbat)

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם צוּר כָּל־הָעוֹלָמִים צַדִּיק בְּכָל־הַדּוֹרוֹת הָאֵל הַנֶּאֱמָן הָאוֹמֵר וְעוֹשֶׂה הַמְדַבֵּר וּמְקַיֵּם שֶׁכָּל־דְּבָרָיו אֱמֶת וְצֶדֶק נֶאֱמָן אַתָּה הוּא יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ וְנֶאֱמָנִים דְּבָרֶיךָ וְדָבָר אֶחָד מִדְּבָרֶיךָ אָחוֹר לֹא יָשׁוּב רֵיקָם כִּי אֵל מֶלֶךְ נֶאֱמָן וְרַחֲמָן אָתָּה בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה הָאֵל הַנֶּאֱמָן בְּכָל־דְּבָרָיו:

רַחֵם עַל צִיּוֹן כִּי הִיא בֵּית חַיֵּינוּ וְלֶעָלוּבַת נֶפֶשׁ תּוֹשִׁיעַ בִּמְהֵרָה בְיָמֵינוּ בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה מְשַׂמֵּחַ צִיּוֹן בְּבָנֶיהָ:

שַׂמְּחֵנוּ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ בְּאֵלִיָּהוּ הַנָּבִיא עַבְדֶּךָ וּבְמַלְכוּת בֵּית דָּוִד מְשִׁיחֶךָ בִּמְהֵרָה יָבֹא וְיָגֵל לִבֵּנוּ עַל כִּסְאוֹ לֹא יֵשֵׁב זָר וְלֹא יִנְחֲלוּ עוֹד אֲחֵרִים אֶת כְּבוֹדוֹ כִּי בְשֵׁם קָדְשְׁךָ נִשְׁבַּעְתָּ לוֹ שֶׁלֹּא יִכְבֶּה נֵרוֹ לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה מָגֵן דָּוִד:

עַל הַתּוֹרָה וְעַל הָעֲבוֹדָה וְעַל הַנְּבִיאִים וְעַל יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת הַזֶּה שֶׁנָּתַתָּ לָנוּ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ לִקְדֻשָּׁה וְלִמְנוּחָה לְכָבוֹד וּלְתִפְאֶרֶת עַל הַכֹּל יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ אֲנַחְנוּ מוֹדִים לָךְ וּמְבָרְכִים אוֹתָךְ יִתְבָּרַךְ שִׁמְךָ בְּפִי כָּל־חַי תָּמִיד לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה מְקַדֵּשׁ הַשַּׁבָּת אָמֵן:

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world, rock of all the worlds, righteous in all generations, the faithful God who says and does, who speaks and fulfils, all of whose words are true and just. You are faithful, LORD our God, and your words are faithful, and not one of your words returns empty, for you are a faithful and merciful God and king. Blessed are you, LORD, the God who is faithful in all his words. Have mercy on Zion, for it is the home of our life, and save the one with a grieving soul quickly in our days. Blessed are you, LORD, who gladdens Zion through her children. Gladden us, LORD our God, with Elijah the prophet your servant and with the kingdom of the house of David your anointed; may he come quickly and make our heart rejoice. On his throne let no stranger sit, and let others not inherit his glory any more, for by your holy name you swore to him that his light would never go out. Blessed are you, LORD, shield of David. For the Torah, and for the service, and for the prophets, and for this Shabbat day which you gave us, LORD our God, for holiness and rest, for honour and glory. For all this, LORD our God, we thank you and bless you. May your name be blessed by every living being, always, for ever. Blessed are you, LORD, who makes the Shabbat holy.

Hebrew: Shaliehsaboo Edition via Sefaria: Siddur Edot HaMizrach, Shabbat Shacharit, Haftarah · licence: CC0. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: transcribed-needs-check · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Edot HaMizrach (Shaliehsaboo edition) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/haftarah-after

Mi sheberach avoteinu (opening words only) Siddur: Mi sheberach, opening words

מִי שֶׁבֵּרַךְ אֲבוֹתֵינוּ אַבְרָהָם יִצְחָק וְיַעֲקֹב

He who blessed our ancestors Abraham, Isaac and Jacob

Hebrew: Torat Emet 357 via Sefaria: Siddur Sefard, Shabbat Morning Services, Prayer for Oleh · licence: Public Domain. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Sefard (Torat Emet) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/mi-sheberach-opening

Birkat Hagomel (after recovery or safe travel) and the congregation's response Siddur: Birkat Hagomel

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם הַגּוֹמֵל לְחַיָּבִים טוֹבוֹת שֶׁגְּמָלַנִי כָּל טוּב׃

מִי שֶׁגְּמָלְךָ טוֹב הוּא יִגְמָלְךָ כָּל־טוּב סֶלָה׃

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world, who bestows good things on the undeserving, and has bestowed every good on me. May the one who has bestowed good on you bestow on you every good. Selah.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Torah Reading, Reading from Sefer, Birkat Hagomel · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/hagomel

Yehalelu (said as the Torah is returned to the ark) Psalm 148:13-14

יְהַלְלוּ אֶת־שֵׁם יְהוָה כִּי־נִשְׂגָּב שְׁמוֹ לְבַדּוֹ הוֹדוֹ עַל־אֶרֶץ וְשָׁמָיִם׃

וַיָּרֶם קֶרֶן לְעַמּוֹ תְּהִלָּה לְכָל־חֲסִידָיו לִבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל עַם־קְרֹבוֹ הַלְלוּ־יָהּ׃

Let them praise the name of the LORD, For His name alone is exalted; His glory is above the earth and heaven. And He hath lifted up a horn for His people, A praise for all His saints, Even for the children of Israel, a people near unto Him. Hallelujah.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/yehalelu

Hashivenu (sung as the Torah is returned; 'Chadesh yameinu kekedem') Lamentations 5:21

הֲשִׁיבֵנוּ יְהוָה אֵלֶיךָ וְנָשׁוּבָה חַדֵּשׁ יָמֵינוּ כְּקֶדֶם׃

Turn Thou us unto Thee, O LORD, and we shall be turned; Renew our days as of old.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/hashivenu

Etz chaim hi (sung as the Torah is returned to the ark) Siddur: Etz chaim hi (Proverbs 3:18, 3:17, 3:16, Isaiah 42:21)

עֵץ חַיִּים הִיא לַמַּחֲזִיקִים בָּהּ וְתוֹמְכֶיהָ מְאֻשָּׁר׃ דְּרָכֶיהָ דַרְכֵי נֹעַם וְכָל נְתִיבוֹתֶיהָ שָׁלוֹם׃

אֹרֶךְ יָמִים בִּימִינָהּ בִּשְׂמֹאלָהּ עֹשֶׁר וְכָבוֹד׃ יְהוָה חָפֵץ לְמַעַן צִדְקוֹ יַגְדִּיל תּוֹרָה וְיַאְדִּיר׃

It is a tree of life to those who hold fast to it, and those who support it are happy. Its ways are ways of pleasantness and all its paths are peace. Length of days is in its right hand, in its left hand riches and honour. The LORD desired, for the sake of his righteousness, to make the Torah great and glorious.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Torah Reading, Reading from Sefer, Raising the Torah · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: transcribed-needs-check · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/etz-chaim

The Amidah, Kedushah and closing prayers

Pieces of the standing prayer, the Kedushah verses, and the prayers that close a service.

Amidah opening (Avot) Siddur: Amidah, first blessing (Avot)

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ וֵאלֹהֵי אֲבוֹתֵינוּ אֱלֹהֵי אַבְרָהָם אֱלֹהֵי יִצְחָק וֵאלֹהֵי יַעֲקֹב הָאֵל הַגָּדוֹל הַגִּבּוֹר
וְהַנּוֹרָא אֵל עֶלְיוֹן גּוֹמֵל חֲסָדִים טוֹבִים קוֹנֵה הַכֹּל וְזוֹכֵר חַסְדֵי אָבוֹת וּמֵבִיא גּוֹאֵל לִבְנֵי בְנֵיהֶם לְמַעַן שְׁמוֹ
בְּאַהֲבָה: מֶלֶךְ עוֹזֵר וּמוֹשִׁיעַ וּמָגֵן:

Blessed are you, LORD our God and God of our ancestors, God of Abraham, God of Isaac and God of Jacob; the great, mighty and awesome God, God Most High, who bestows loving-kindnesses, creates all things, remembers the kindnesses of the ancestors, and brings a redeemer to their children's children for the sake of his name, in love. King, helper, saviour and shield.

Hebrew: Shaliehsaboo Edition via Sefaria: Siddur Edot HaMizrach, Weekday Shacharit, Amida · licence: CC0. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Edot HaMizrach (Shaliehsaboo edition) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/avot-1

Amidah first blessing, closing (Magen Avraham) Siddur: Amidah, first blessing, closing lines

מֶלֶךְ עוֹזֵר וּמוֹשִׁיעַ וּמָגֵן: בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה מָגֵן אַבְרָהָם:

King, helper, saviour and shield. Blessed are you, LORD, shield of Abraham.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Amidah, Patriarchs · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/avot-closing

Amidah preface: open my lips Psalm 51:17 (Amidah preface)

אֲדֹנָי שְׂפָתַי תִּפְתָּח וּפִי יַגִּיד תְּהִלָּתֶךָ:

My Lord, open my lips, and my mouth will declare your praise.

Hebrew: Shaliehsaboo Edition via Sefaria: Siddur Edot HaMizrach, Weekday Shacharit, Amida · licence: CC0. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Edot HaMizrach (Shaliehsaboo edition) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/amidah-lips

Kadosh, kadosh, kadosh (Kedushah) Isaiah 6:3

וְקָרָא זֶה אֶל־זֶה וְאָמַר קָדוֹשׁ קָדוֹשׁ קָדוֹשׁ יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת מְלֹא כָל־הָאָרֶץ כְּבוֹדוֹ:

And one called unto another, and said: Holy, holy, holy, is the LORD of hosts; The whole earth is full of His glory.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/kedushah-kadosh

Baruch kevod Adonai mimkomo (Kedushah) Ezekiel 3:12 (last three words)

בָּרוּךְ כְּבוֹד־יְהוָה מִמְּקוֹמוֹ׃

Blessed be the glory of the LORD from his place.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/kedushah-baruch

Yimloch Adonai l'olam (Kedushah) Psalm 146:10

יִמְלֹךְ יְהוָה לְעוֹלָם אֱלֹהַיִךְ צִיּוֹן לְדֹר וָדֹר הַלְלוּ־יָהּ׃

The LORD will reign for ever, Thy God, O Zion, unto all generations. Hallelujah.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/kedushah-yimloch

Sim shalom (peace blessing of the morning Amidah) Siddur: Amidah, Sim shalom (morning)

שִׂים שָׁלוֹם טוֹבָה וּבְרָכָה חֵן וָחֶסֶד וְרַחֲמִים עָלֵינוּ וְעַל כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל עַמֶּךָ בָּרְכֵנוּ אָבִינוּ כֻּלָּנוּ כְּאֶחָד בְּאוֹר
פָּנֶיךָ כִּי בְאוֹר פָּנֶיךָ נָתַתָּ לָּנוּ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ תּוֹרַת חַיִּים וְאַהֲבַת חֶסֶד וּצְדָקָה וּבְרָכָה וְרַחֲמִים וְחַיִּים וְשָׁלוֹם
וְטוֹב בְּעֵינֶיךָ לְבָרֵךְ אֶת עַמְּךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּכָל־עֵת וּבְכָל־שָׁעָה בִּשְׁלוֹמֶךָ׃
בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה הַמְבָרֵךְ אֶת־עַמּוֹ יִשְׂרָאֵל בַּשָּׁלוֹם׃

Grant peace, goodness and blessing, grace, kindness and mercy upon us and upon all Israel your people. Bless us, our father, all of us as one, with the light of your face; for by the light of your face you gave us, LORD our God, a Torah of life, love of kindness, righteousness, blessing, mercy, life and peace. And may it be good in your eyes to bless your people Israel at every time and every hour with your peace. Blessed are you, LORD, who blesses his people Israel with peace.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Amidah, Peace · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/sim-shalom

Yihyu leratzon imrei fi (verse that closes the Amidah) Siddur: Amidah, closing verse (Psalm 19:15)

יִהְיוּ לְרָצוֹן אִמְרֵי פִי וְהֶגְיוֹן לִבִּי לְפָנֶיךָ יְהוָה צוּרִי וְגוֹאֲלִי׃

May the words of my mouth and the thoughts of my heart be acceptable before you, LORD, my rock and my redeemer.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Amidah, Concluding Passage · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/amidah-yihyu

Elohai netzor (private prayer ending the Amidah) Siddur: Amidah, Elohai netzor

אֱלֹהַי נְצוֹר לְשׁוֹנִי מֵרָע וּשְׂפָתַי מִדַּבֵּר מִרְמָה וְלִמְקַלְלַי נַפְשִׁי תִדּוֹם וְנַפְשִׁי כֶּעָפָר לַכֹּל תִּהְיֶה פְּתַח לִבִּי בְּתוֹרָתֶךָ וּבְמִצְוֹתֶיךָ תִּרְדֹּף נַפְשִׁי וְכֹל הַחוֹשְׁבִים עָלַי רָעָה מְהֵרָה הָפֵר עֲצָתָם וְקַלְקֵל מַחֲשַׁבְתָּם: עֲשֵׂה לְמַעַן שְׁמֶךָ עֲשֵׂה לְמַעַן יְמִינֶךָ עֲשֵׂה לְמַעַן קְדֻשָּׁתֶךָ עֲשֵׂה לְמַעַן תּוֹרָתֶךָ לְמַעַן יֵחָלְצוּן יְדִידֶיךָ הוֹשִׁיעָה יְמִינְךָ וַעֲנֵנִי: יִהְיוּ לְרָצוֹן אִמְרֵי פִי וְהֶגְיוֹן לִבִּי לְפָנֶיךָ יְהוָה צוּרִי וְגוֹאֲלִי:

My God, guard my tongue from evil and my lips from speaking deceit. To those who curse me, let my soul be silent; let my soul be like dust to all. Open my heart to your Torah, and let my soul pursue your commandments. As for all who plan evil against me, quickly annul their counsel and frustrate their plans. Act for the sake of your name; act for the sake of your right hand; act for the sake of your holiness; act for the sake of your Torah. That your beloved may be rescued, save with your right hand and answer me. May the words of my mouth and the thoughts of my heart be acceptable before you, LORD, my rock and my redeemer.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Amidah, Concluding Passage · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/amidah-elohai-netzor

Oseh shalom (end of the Amidah and of Kaddish) Siddur: Oseh shalom

עֹשֶׂה שָׁלוֹם בִּמְרוֹמָיו הוּא יַעֲשֶׂה שָׁלוֹם עָלֵינוּ וְעַל כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאִמְרוּ אָמֵן:

He who makes peace in his high places, may he make peace for us and for all Israel; and say: Amen.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Amidah, Concluding Passage · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/oseh-shalom

Aleinu, first paragraph Siddur: Aleinu (first paragraph)

עָלֵינוּ לְשַׁבֵּחַ לָאָדוֹן הַכֹּל לָתֵת גְּדֻלָּה לְיוֹצֵר בְּרֵאשִׁית שֶׁלֹּא עָשָׂנוּ כְּגוֹיֵי הָאֲרָצוֹת וְלֹא שָׂמָנוּ כְּמִשְׁפְּחוֹת הָאֲדָמָה שֶׁלֹּא שָׂם חֶלְקֵנוּ כָּהֶם וְגוֹרָלֵנוּ כְּכָל־הֲמוֹנָם שֶׁהֵם מִשְׁתַּחֲוִים לְהֶבֶל וְרִיק וּמִתְפַּלְלִים אֶל־אֵל לֹא יוֹשִׁיעַ וַאֲנַחְנוּ מִשְׁתַּחֲוִים לִפְנֵי מֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שֶׁהוּא נוֹטֶה שָׁמַיִם וְיוֹסֵד אָרֶץ וּמוֹשַׁב יְקָרוֹ בַּשָּׁמַיִם מִמַּעַל וּשְׁכִינַת עֻזּוֹ בְּגָבְהֵי מְרוֹמִים הוּא אֱלֹהֵינוּ וְאֵין עוֹד אַחֵר אֱמֶת מַלְכֵּנוּ וְאֶפֶס זוּלָתוֹ כַּכָּתוּב בַּתּוֹרָה וְיָדַעְתָּ הַיּוֹם וַהֲשֵׁבֹתָ אֶל־לְבָבֶךָ כִּי יְהוָה הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים בַּשָּׁמַיִם מִמַּעַל וְעַל־הָאָרֶץ מִתָּחַת אֵין עוֹד:

It is our duty to praise the Master of all, to ascribe greatness to the Creator of the beginning: that he has not made us like the nations of the lands and has not placed us like the families of the earth, that he has not set our portion like theirs nor our lot like all their multitude. For they bow to vanity and emptiness and pray to a god who does not save; but we bow before the King of kings of kings, the Holy One, blessed be he, who stretches out the heavens and founds the earth, whose seat of glory is in the heavens above and the presence of his might in the loftiest heights. He is our God; there is no other. Truly he is our king; there is nothing besides him. As it is written in the Torah: "You shall know this day and take it to heart that the LORD is God, in the heavens above and on the earth beneath; there is no other."

Hebrew: Shaliehsaboo Edition via Sefaria: Siddur Edot HaMizrach, Weekday Shacharit, Alenu · licence: CC0. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Edot HaMizrach (Shaliehsaboo edition) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/aleinu-1

Mourner's Kaddish Siddur: Mourner's Kaddish

יִתְגַּדַּל וְיִתְקַדַּשׁ שְׁמֵהּ רַבָּא אָמֵן

בְּעָלְמָא דִּי־בְרָא כִרְעוּתֵהּ וְיַמְלִיךְ מַלְכוּתֵהּ בְּחַיֵּיכוֹן וּבְיוֹמֵיכוֹן וּבְחַיֵּי דְכָל־בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל בַּעֲגָלָא וּבִזְמַן קָרִיב וְאִמְרוּ אָמֵן:

יְהֵא שְׁמֵהּ רַבָּא מְבָרַךְ לְעָלַם וּלְעָלְמֵי עָלְמַיָּא

יִתְבָּרַךְ וְיִשְׁתַּבַּח וְיִתְפָּאַר וְיִתְרוֹמַם וְיִתְנַשֵּׂא וְיִתְהַדַּר וְיִתְעַלֶּה וְיִתְהַלַּל שְׁמֵהּ דְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא

לְעֵלָּא מִן־כָּל־בִּרְכָתָא וְשִׁירָתָא תֻּשְׁבְּחָתָא וְנֶחֱמָתָא דַּאֲמִירָן בְּעָלְמָא וְאִמְרוּ אָמֵן:

יְהֵא שְׁלָמָא רַבָּא מִן־שְׁמַיָּא וְחַיִּים עָלֵינוּ וְעַל־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאִמְרוּ אָמֵן:

עוֹשֶׂה שָׁלוֹם בִּמְרוֹמָיו הוּא יַעֲשֶׂה שָׁלוֹם עָלֵינוּ וְעַל כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאִמְרוּ אָמֵן:

Magnified and sanctified be his great name. (Amen.) In the world that he created by his will; may he establish his kingdom in your lifetime and in your days and in the lifetime of all the house of Israel, speedily and soon; and say: Amen. May his great name be blessed for ever and for all eternities. Blessed, praised, glorified, exalted, extolled, honoured, raised and lauded be the name of the Holy One, blessed be he, beyond all the blessings and songs, praises and consolations that are uttered in the world; and say: Amen. May there be great peace from heaven, and life, for us and for all Israel; and say: Amen. He who makes peace in his high places, may he make peace for us and for all Israel; and say: Amen.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Concluding Prayers, Mourner's Kaddish · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/kaddish-1

Adon Olam Siddur: Adon Olam

אֲדוֹן עוֹלָם אֲשֶׁר מָלַךְ בְּטֶרֶם כָּל יְצִיר נִבְרָא:

לְעֵת נַעֲשָׂה בְחֶפְצוֹ כֹּל אֲזַי מֶלֶךְ שְׁמוֹ נִקְרָא:

וְאַחֲרֵי כִּכְלוֹת הַכֹּל לְבַדּוֹ יִמְלֹךְ נוֹרָא:

וְהוּא הָיָה וְהוּא הֹוֶה וְהוּא יִהְיֶה בְּתִפְאָרָה:

וְהוּא אֶחָד וְאֵין שֵׁנִי לְהַמְשִׁיל לוֹ לְהַחְבִּירָה:

בְּלִי רֵאשִׁית בְּלִי תַכְלִית וְלוֹ הָעֹז וְהַמִּשְׂרָה:

וְהוּא אֵלִי וְחַי גּוֹאֲלִי וְצוּר חֶבְלִי בְּעֵת צָרָה:

וְהוּא נִסִּי וּמָנוֹס לִי מָנָת כּוֹסִי בְּיוֹם אֶקְרָא:

בְּיָדוֹ אַפְקִיד רוּחִי בְּעֵת אִישַׁן וְאָעִירָה:

וְעִם רוּחִי גְּוִיָּתִי יְהוָה לִי וְלֹא אִירָא:

Lord of the world, who reigned before any form was created. At the time when all was made by his will, then "King" was his name proclaimed. And after all things have ended, he alone, the awesome one, will reign. And he was, and he is, and he will be, in glory. And he is one, and there is no second, to compare to him or to join with him. Without beginning, without end; to him belong the power and the dominion. And he is my God, and my living redeemer, and the rock of my portion in time of distress. And he is my banner and my refuge, the portion of my cup on the day I call. Into his hand I commit my spirit, when I sleep and when I wake. And with my spirit, my body too: the LORD is with me and I will not fear.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Preparatory Prayers, Adon Olam · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/adon-olam-1

Yigdal (hymn of the Thirteen Principles) Siddur: Yigdal

יִגְדַּל אֱלֹהִים חַי וְיִשְׁתַּבַּח נִמְצָא וְאֵין עֵת אֶל מְצִיאוּתוֹ׃
אֶחָד וְאֵין יָחִיד כְּיִחוּדוֹ נֶעְלָם וְגַם אֵין סוֹף לְאַחְדוּתוֹ׃
אֵין לוֹ דְמוּת הַגּוּף וְאֵינוֹ גוּף לֹא נַעֲרֹךְ אֵלָיו קְדֻשָּׁתוֹ׃
קַדְמוֹן לְכָל־דָּבָר אֲשֶׁר נִבְרָא רִאשׁוֹן וְאֵין רֵאשִׁית לְרֵאשִׁיתוֹ׃
הִנּוֹ אֲדוֹן עוֹלָם לְכָל־נוֹצָר יוֹרֶה גְדֻלָּתוֹ וּמַלְכוּתוֹ׃
שֶׁפַע נְבוּאָתוֹ נָתַנּוֹ אֶל אַנְשֵׁי סְגֻלָּתוֹ וְתִפְאַרְתּוֹ׃
לֹא קָם בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל כְּמֹשֶׁה עוֹד נָבִיא וּמַבִּיט אֶת־תְּמוּנָתוֹ׃
תּוֹרַת אֱמֶת נָתַן לְעַמּוֹ אֵל עַל יַד נְבִיאוֹ נֶאֱמַן בֵּיתוֹ׃
לֹא יַחֲלִיף הָאֵל וְלֹא יָמִיר דָּתוֹ לְעוֹלָמִים לְזוּלָתוֹ׃
צוֹפֶה וְיוֹדֵעַ סְתָרֵינוּ מַבִּיט לְסוֹף דָּבָר בְּקַדְמָתוֹ׃
גּוֹמֵל לְאִישׁ חֶסֶד כְּמִפְעָלוֹ נוֹתֵן לָרָשָׁע רָע כְּרִשְׁעָתוֹ׃
יִשְׁלַח לְקֵץ הַיָּמִין מְשִׁיחֵנוּ לִפְדּוֹת מְחַכֵּי קֵץ יְשׁוּעָתוֹ׃
מֵתִים יְחַיֶּה אֵל בְּרֹב חַסְדּוֹ בָּרוּךְ עֲדֵי עַד שֵׁם תְּהִלָּתוֹ׃

May the living God be magnified and praised; he exists, and his existence is not bound by time. He is one, and there is no unity like his unity; hidden, and without end to his oneness. He has no bodily form and is not a body; his holiness cannot be compared. He preceded everything that was created; first, and with no beginning to his beginning. Behold, he is master of the world to every creature; he shows his greatness and his sovereignty. The abundance of his prophecy he gave to the people he treasured and who are his glory. No one has arisen in Israel like Moses, a prophet who beheld his likeness. A Torah of truth God gave to his people through his prophet, trusted in his house. God will not alter or exchange his law, for ever, for any other. He watches and knows our secrets; he sees the end of a matter at its beginning. He repays a person with kindness according to his deeds; he gives the wicked evil according to his wickedness. At the end of days he will send our anointed one, to redeem those who await the end of his salvation. God will revive the dead in his great kindness; blessed for ever is his praised name.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Weekday, Shacharit, Preparatory Prayers, Yigdal · licence: CC-BY.
English: original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: transcribed-needs-check · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/yigdal

Shabbat, Psalms and the table

Friday night and Shabbat day, Havdalah, Ashrei, and the blessings around a meal.

Lecha Dodi (refrain and first verse) Siddur: Lecha Dodi, refrain and first verse

לְכָה דוֹדִי לִקְרַאת כַּלָּה פְּנֵי שַׁבָּת נְקַבְּלָה׃

שָׁמוֹר וְזָכוֹר בְּדִבּוּר אֶחָד הִשְׁמִיעָנוּ אֵל הַמְיוּחָד יְהוָה אֶחָד וּשְׁמוֹ אֶחָד לְשֵׁם וּלְתִפְאֶרֶת וְלִתְהִלָּה׃

Come, my beloved, to meet the bride; let us welcome the presence of Shabbat. "Keep" and "remember" in a single utterance, the one God made us hear; the LORD is one and his name is one, for renown, for glory and for praise.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Shabbat, Kabbalat Shabbat, Lekha Dodi · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/lecha-dodi-1

Blessing over wine Siddur: blessing over wine

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם בּוֹרֵא פְּרִי הַגָּפֶן׃

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world, who creates the fruit of the vine.

Hebrew: Torat Emet 357 via Sefaria: Siddur Sefard, Birchat HaMazon, Blessing on Foods · licence: Public Domain. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Sefard (Torat Emet) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/kiddush-wine-1

Kiddush for Shabbat evening (the sanctification blessing) Siddur: Kiddush for Friday night, the sanctification

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם אֲשֶׁר קִדְּשָׁנוּ בְּמִצְוֹתָיו וְרָצָה בָנוּ וְשַׁבַּת קָדְשׁוֹ בְּאַהֲבָה וּבְרָצוֹן הִנְחִילָנוּ זִכָּרוֹן לְמַעֲשֵׂה בְרֵאשִׁית כִּי הוּא יוֹם תְּחִלָּה לְמִקְרָאֵי קֹדֶשׁ זֵכֶר לִיצִיאַת מִצְרָיִם כִּי בָנוּ בָחַרְתָּ וְאוֹתָנוּ קִדַּשְׁתָּ מִכָּל הָעַמִּים וְשַׁבַּת קָדְשְׁךָ בְּאַהֲבָה וּבְרָצוֹן הִנְחַלְתָּנוּ בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה מְקַדֵּשׁ הַשַּׁבָּת׃

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world, who made us holy with his commandments and was pleased with us, and in love and favour gave us his holy Shabbat as an inheritance, a remembrance of the work of creation. For it is the first of the holy convocations, a remembrance of the exodus from Egypt. For you chose us and made us holy from all the peoples, and in love and favour you gave us your holy Shabbat as an inheritance. Blessed are you, LORD, who makes the Shabbat holy.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Ashkenaz, Shabbat, Shabbat Evening, Kiddush · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/kiddush-shabbat-eve

Shabbat candle blessing Siddur: Shabbat candle blessing

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם אֲשֶׁר קִדְּשָׁנוּ בְּמִצְוֹתָיו וְצִוָּנוּ לְהַדְלִיק נֵר שֶׁל שַׁבָּת׃

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world, who made us holy with his commandments and commanded us to light the lamp of Shabbat.

Hebrew: Torat Emet 357 via Sefaria: Siddur Sefard, Shabbat Candle Lighting · licence: Public Domain. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Sefard (Torat Emet) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/candle-shabbat

Kiddush (Shabbat verses) Genesis 2:1-3

וַיְכֻלּוּ הַשָּׁמַיִם וְהָאָרֶץ וְכָל־צְבָאָם׃

וַיְכַל אֱלֹהִים בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי מְלַאכְתּוֹ אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וַיִּשְׁבֹּת בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי מִכָּל־מְלַאכְתּוֹ אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה׃

וַיְבָרֶךְ אֱלֹהִים אֶת־יוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי וַיְקַדֵּשׁ אֹתוֹ כִּי בוֹ שָׁבַת מִכָּל־מְלַאכְתּוֹ אֲשֶׁר־בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים לַעֲשׂוֹת׃

And the heaven and the earth were finished, and all the host of them. And on the seventh day God finished His work which He had made; and He rested on the seventh day from all His work which He had made. And God blessed the seventh day, and hallowed it; because that in it He rested from all His work which God in creating had made.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/kiddush-gen-2-1-3

V'shamru (Shabbat-day Kiddush; also in the Shabbat Amidah) Exodus 31:16-17

וְשָׁמְרוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־הַשַּׁבָּת לַעֲשׂוֹת אֶת־הַשַּׁבָּת לְדֹרֹתָם בְּרִית עוֹלָם׃

בֵּינִי וּבֵין בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אוֹת הִוא לְעֹלָם כִּי־שֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים עָשָׂה יְהוָה אֶת־הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֶת־הָאָרֶץ וּבַיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי שָׁבַת וַיִּנָּפַשׁ׃

Wherefore the children of Israel shall keep the sabbath, to observe the sabbath throughout their generations, for a perpetual covenant. It is a sign between Me and the children of Israel for ever; for in six days the LORD made heaven and earth, and on the seventh day He ceased from work and rested.'

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/kiddush-veshamru

Zachor et yom hashabbat (Shabbat-day Kiddush, second passage) Exodus 20:8-11

זָכוֹר אֶת־יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת לְקַדְּשׁוֹ
שֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים תַּעֲבֹד וְעָשִׂיתָ כָּל־מְלַאכְתֶּךָ
וְיוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי שַׁבָּת לַיהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לֹא־תַעֲשֶׂה כָל־מְלָאכָה אַתָּה וּבִנְךָ־וּבִתֶּךָ עַבְדְּךָ וַאֲמָתֶךָ וּבְהֶמְתֶּךָ וְגֵרְךָ
אֲשֶׁר בִּשְׁעָרֶיךָ
כִּי שֵׁשֶׁת־יָמִים עָשָׂה יְהוָה אֶת־הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֶת־הָאָרֶץ אֶת־הַיָּם וְאֶת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־בָּם וַיָּנַח בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי עַל־כֵּן
בֵּרַךְ יְהוָה אֶת־יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת וַיְקַדְּשֵׁהוּ׃

Remember the sabbath day, to keep it holy. Six days shalt thou labour, and do all thy work; but the seventh day is a sabbath unto the LORD thy God, in it thou shalt not do any manner of work, thou, nor thy son, nor thy daughter, nor thy man-servant, nor thy maid-servant, nor thy cattle, nor thy stranger that is within thy gates; for in six days the LORD made heaven and earth, the sea, and all that in them is, and rested on the seventh day; wherefore the LORD blessed the sabbath day, and hallowed it.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/kiddush-zachor

Hinei El yeshuati (opening of Havdalah) Siddur: Havdalah, opening verses (Hinei El yeshuati)

הִנֵּה אֵל יְשׁוּעָתִי אֶבְטַח וְלֹא אֶפְחָד: כִּי עָזִּי וְזִמְרָת יָהּ יְהוָה וַיְהִי לִי לִישׁוּעָה: וּשְׁאַבְתֶּם מַיִם בְּשָׂשׂוֹן
מִמַּעַיְנֵי הַיְשׁוּעָה: לַיהוָה הַיְשׁוּעָה עַל עַמְּךָ בִרְכָתֶךָ סֶּלָה: יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת עִמָּנוּ מִשְׂגָּב לָנוּ אֱלֹהֵי יַעֲקֹב סֶּלָה:
יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת אַשְׁרֵי אָדָם בֹּטֵחַ בָּךְ: יְהוָה הוֹשִׁיעָה הַמֶּלֶךְ יַעֲנֵנוּ בְיוֹם קָרְאֵנוּ: לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה
וְשִׂמְחָה וְשָׂשׂוֹן וְיִקָר כֵּן תִּהְיֶה לָנוּ: כּוֹס יְשׁוּעוֹת אֶשָּׂא וּבְשֵׁם יְהוָה אֶקְרָא:

Behold, God is my salvation; I will trust and not be afraid, for the LORD God is my strength and my song, and he has become my salvation. You will draw water with joy from the springs of salvation. Salvation belongs to the LORD; your blessing is upon your people, Selah. The LORD of hosts is with us; the God of Jacob is our stronghold, Selah. LORD of hosts, happy is the one who trusts in you. LORD, save; may the King answer us on the day we call. The Jews had light and gladness, joy and honour; so may it be for us. I will lift the cup of salvation and call on the name of the LORD.

Hebrew: Torat Emet 357 via Sefaria: Siddur Sefard, Motzaei Shabbat , Havdala · licence: Public Domain. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Sefard (Torat Emet) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/havdalah-opening

Havdalah: blessing over spices (besamim) Siddur: Havdalah, blessing over spices

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם בּוֹרֵא מִינֵי בְשָׂמִים׃

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world, who creates kinds of spices.

Hebrew: Torat Emet 357 via Sefaria: Siddur Sefard, Motzaei Shabbat , Havdala · licence: Public Domain. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Sefard (Torat Emet) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/havdalah-spices

Havdalah: blessing over the flame Siddur: Havdalah, blessing over the flame

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם בּוֹרֵא מְאוֹרֵי הָאֵשׁ׃

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world, who creates the lights of the fire.

Hebrew: Shaliehsaboo Edition via Sefaria: Siddur Edot HaMizrach, Havdalah, Havdala · licence: CC0. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Edot HaMizrach (Shaliehsaboo edition) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/havdalah-flame

Havdalah: Hamavdil bein kodesh lechol Siddur: Havdalah, the separation blessing

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם הַמַּבְדִּיל בֵּין קֹדֶשׁ לְחוֹל וּבֵין אוֹר לְחֹשֶׁךְ וּבֵין יִשְׂרָאֵל לָעַמִּים וּבֵין יוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי לְשֵׁשֶׁת יְמֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה הַמַּבְדִּיל בֵּין קֹדֶשׁ לְחוֹל׃

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world, who separates between holy and ordinary, between light and darkness, between Israel and the nations, between the seventh day and the six days of work. Blessed are you, LORD, who separates between holy and ordinary.

Hebrew: Shaliehsaboo Edition via Sefaria: Siddur Edot HaMizrach, Havdalah, Havdala · licence: CC0. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Edot HaMizrach (Shaliehsaboo edition) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/havdalah-hamavdil

Ashrei yoshvei veitecha (first line of Ashrei) Psalm 84:5

אַשְׁרֵי יוֹשְׁבֵי בֵיתֶךָ עוֹד יְהַלְלוּךָ סֶּלָה׃

Happy are they that dwell in Thy house, they are ever praising Thee. Selah

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/ashrei-84-5

Ashrei ha-am she-kacha lo (second line of Ashrei) Psalm 144:15

אַשְׁרֵי הָעָם שֶׁכָּכָה לּוֹ אַשְׁרֵי הָעָם שֶׁיְּהוָה אֱלֹהָיו׃

Happy is the people that is in such a case. Yea, happy is the people whose God is the LORD.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/ashrei-144-15

Tehilah l'David (Psalm 145, opening verses of Ashrei) Psalm 145:1-3

תְּהִלָּה לְדָוִד אֲרוֹמִמְךָ אֱלוֹהַי הַמֶּלֶךְ וַאֲבָרְכָה שִׁמְךָ לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד׃

בְּכָל־יוֹם אֲבָרְכֶךָּ וַאֲהַלְלָה שִׁמְךָ לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד׃

גָּדוֹל יְהוָה וּמְהֻלָּל מְאֹד וְלִגְדֻלָּתוֹ אֵין חֵקֶר׃

[A Psalm of] praise; of David. I will extol Thee, my God, O King; And I will bless Thy name for ever and ever. Every day will I bless Thee; And I will praise Thy name for ever and ever. Great is the LORD, and highly to be praised; And His greatness is unsearchable.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/ashrei-145-1-3

Poteach et yadecha (the verse said with concentration in Ashrei) Psalm 145:16

פּוֹתֵחַ אֶת־יָדֶךָ וּמַשְׂבִּיעַ לְכָל־חַי רָצוֹן׃

Thou openest Thy hand, And satisfiest every living thing with favour.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/ashrei-145-16

Shir hamaalot (sung before Birkat Hamazon on Shabbat and festivals) Psalm 126:1-6

שִׁיר הַמַּעֲלוֹת בְּשׁוּב יְהוָה אֶת־שִׁיבַת צִיּוֹן הָיִינוּ כְּחֹלְמִים׃

אָז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ וּלְשׁוֹנֵנוּ רִנָּה אָז יֹאמְרוּ בַגּוֹיִם הִגְדִּיל יְהוָה לַעֲשׂוֹת עִם־אֵלֶּה׃

הִגְדִּיל יְהוָה לַעֲשׂוֹת עִמָּנוּ הָיִינוּ שְׂמֵחִים׃

שׁוּבָה יְהוָה אֶת־שבותנו כַּאֲפִיקִים בַּנֶּגֶב׃

הַזֹּרְעִים בְּדִמְעָה בְּרִנָּה יִקְצֹרוּ׃

הָלוֹךְ יֵלֵךְ וּבָכֹה נֹשֵׂא מֶשֶׁךְ־הַזָּרַע בֹּא־יָבוֹא בְרִנָּה נֹשֵׂא אֲלֻמֹּתָיו׃

A Song of Ascents. When the LORD brought back those that returned to Zion, We were like unto them that dream. Then was our mouth filled with laughter, and our tongue with singing; then said they among the nations: 'The LORD hath done great things with these.' The LORD hath done great things with us; we are rejoiced. Turn our captivity, O LORD, as the streams in the dry land. They that sow in tears Shall reap in joy. Though he goeth on his way weeping that beareth the measure of seed, He shall come home with joy, bearing his sheaves.

Hebrew: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026) · licence: Public Domain / copy without restriction (tanach.us/License.html). **English:** JPS 1917 (The Holy Scriptures: A New Translation) (Public Domain). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · https://alef.example.org/#/read/shir-hamaalot

Zimun: "Rabotai nevarech" and the response

Siddur: Birkat Hamazon, zimun (invitation)

רַבּוֹתַי נְבָרֵךְ׃

יְהִי שֵׁם יְהוָה מְבֹרָךְ מֵעַתָּה וְעַד־עוֹלָם׃

Gentlemen, let us bless. May the name of the LORD be blessed from now and for ever.

Hebrew: The Metsudah siddur, 1981 via Sefaria: Siddur Sefard, Birchat HaMazon, Birchat HaMazon · licence: CC-BY. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Ashkenaz (Metsudah) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/zimun-opening

Birkat Hamazon opener (HaZan et haolam)

Siddur: Birkat Hamazon, first blessing (opening)

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם הַזָּן אֶת הָעוֹלָם כֻּלּוֹ בְּטוּבוֹ בְּחֵן בְּחֶסֶד וּבְרַחֲמִים הוּא נוֹתֵן לֶחֶם לְכָל בָּשָׂר כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ׃

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world, who feeds the whole world, all of it, in his goodness, with grace, kindness and mercy. He gives bread to all flesh, for his kindness is for ever.

Hebrew: Torat Emet 357 via Sefaria: Siddur Sefard, Birchat HaMazon, Birchat HaMazon · licence: Public Domain. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Sefard (Torat Emet) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/birkat-hamazon-1

Hanukkah

The candle blessings and songs.

Hanukkah: blessing to light the candles

Siddur: Hanukkah candle blessing

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם אֲשֶׁר קִדְּשָׁנוּ בְּמִצְוֹתָיו וְצִוָּנוּ לְהַדְלִיק נֵר חֲנֻכָּה׃

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world, who made us holy with his commandments and commanded us to light the Hanukkah light.

Hebrew: Shaliehsaboo Edition via Sefaria: Siddur Edot HaMizrach, Hanukkah, Menorah Lighting · licence: CC0. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Edot HaMizrach (Shaliehsaboo edition) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/hanukkah-candle

Hanukkah: sheasah nissim (who performed miracles)

Siddur: Hanukkah, blessing for the miracles

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם שֶׁעָשָׂה נִסִּים לַאֲבוֹתֵינוּ בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה׃

Blessed are you, LORD our God, king of the world, who performed miracles for our ancestors in those days, at this time.

Hebrew: Shaliehsaboo Edition via Sefaria: Siddur Edot HaMizrach, Hanukkah, Menorah Lighting · licence: CC0. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Edot HaMizrach (Shaliehsaboo edition) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/hanukkah-nissim

Hanerot halalu (said while lighting Hanukkah candles)

Siddur: Hanerot halalu

הַנֵּרוֹת הַלָּלוּ אֲנַחְנוּ מַדְלִיקִין עַל הַנִּסִּים וְעַל הַתְּשׁוּעוֹת וְעַל הַנִּפְלָאוֹת שֶׁעָשִׂיתָ לַאֲבוֹתֵינוּ עַל יְדֵי כֹּהֲנֶיךָ הַקְּדוֹשִׁים וְכָל־שְׁמוֹנַת יְמֵי חֲנֻכָּה הַנֵּרוֹת הַלָּלוּ קֹדֶשׁ וְאֵין לָנוּ רְשׁוּת לְהִשְׁתַּמֵּשׁ בָּהֶם אֶלָּא לִרְאוֹתָם בִּלְבָד כְּדֵי לְהוֹדוֹת לִשְׁמְךָ עַל נִסֶּיךָ נִפְלְאוֹתֶיךָ וִישׁוּעוֹתֶיךָ׃

We light these lights for the miracles, the deliverances, and the wonders that you did for our ancestors through your holy priests. Throughout the eight days of Hanukkah these lights are holy, and we may not use them, only look at them, in order to thank and praise your name for your miracles, your wonders and your salvations.

Hebrew: Shaliehsaboo Edition via Sefaria: Siddur Edot HaMizrach, Hanukkah, Menorah Lighting · licence: CC0. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Edot HaMizrach (Shaliehsaboo edition) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/hanerot-halalu

Maoz Tzur (first verse)

Siddur: Maoz Tzur, first verse

מָעוֹז צוּר יְשׁוּעָתִי לְךָ נָאֶה לְשַׁבֵּחַ תִּכּוֹן בֵּית תְּפִלָּתִי וְשָׁם תּוֹדָה נְזַבֵּחַ לְעֵת תָּכִין מַטְבֵּחַ

מִצַּר הַמְנַבֵּחַ אָז אֶגְמוֹר בְּשִׁיר מִזְמוֹר חֲנֻכַּת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ׃

Rock of my salvation, to praise you is fitting. Restore my house of prayer, and there we will bring a thanksgiving offering. When you have prepared the slaughter of the barking foe, then I shall complete with a song of psalm the dedication of the altar.

Hebrew: Shaliehsaboo Edition via Sefaria: Siddur Edot HaMizrach, Hanukkah, Menorah Lighting · licence: CC0. **English:** original-gloss (original (project-owned)). Status: verified · **not proofread** · proofread: no, typed from memory: no · text tradition: Edot HaMizrach (Shaliehsaboo edition) · https://alef.example.org/#/read/maoz-tzur-1

Survival Hebrew

204 phrases from data/corpus/phrasebook.json in 10 situations. Transliteration is the project's own rendering. **Every phrase is flagged "native-speaker-needed" in the data** (pointing and register); slang is tagged.

Greetings (27)

שָׁלוֹם	**shalom**	hello / goodbye / peace Works for both hello and goodbye.
הֵי	**hey**	hi slang Very casual, borrowed from English.
בֹּקֶר טוֹב	**boker tov**	good morning
צָהֳרַיִם טוֹבִים	**tsohorayim tovim**	good afternoon Said around midday.
עֶרֶב טוֹב	**erev tov**	good evening
לַיְלָה טוֹב	**layla tov**	good night
שַׁבָּת שָׁלוֹם	**shabbat shalom**	peaceful Sabbath (greeting from Friday afternoon to Saturday)
שָׁבוּעַ טוֹב	**shavua tov**	good week Said after Shabbat ends, on Saturday night and Sunday.
חַג שָׂמֵחַ	**chag sameach**	happy holiday Used on Jewish holidays.
שָׁנָה טוֹבָה	**shana tova**	happy new year (Rosh Hashana greeting)
מַה שְׁלוֹמְךָ?	**ma shlomcha?**	how are you? Masculine singular; feminine below.
מָה נִשְׁמָע?	**ma nishma?**	what's up? (lit. what is heard?) Same for everyone.
מָה קוֹרֶה?	**ma kore?**	what's happening? slang
הַכֹּל בְּסֵדֶר	**hakol beseder**	everything is OK
בְּסֵדֶר	**beseder**	OK / fine / alright
מְצֻיָּן	**metsuyan**	excellent Often the answer to ma nishma.
לֹא רַע	**lo ra**	not bad

כָּכָה כָּכָה	**kacha kacha**	so-so
נָעִים מְאֹד	**naim meod**	nice to meet you
לְהִתְרָאוֹת	**lehitra'ot**	see you (later)
יוֹם נָעִים	**yom naim**	have a nice day
בָּרוּךְ הַבָּא	**baruch haba**	welcome (to one person) To a man; to a woman: brucha haba'a.
בְּרוּכִים הַבָּאִים	**brukhim haba'im**	welcome (to several people) Plural; the feminine plural is brukhot haba'ot.
מַזָּל טוֹב	**mazal tov**	congratulations / good luck
בְּהַצְלָחָה	**behatslacha**	good luck / all the best
לִבְרִיאוּת	**livri'ut**	bless you (after a sneeze) / to your health
תִּשְׁמֹר עַל עַצְמְךָ	**tishmor al atsmecha**	take care of yourself Masculine; feminine below.

Politeness (22)

תּוֹדָה	**toda**	thank you
תּוֹדָה רַבָּה	**toda raba**	thank you very much
בְּבַקָּשָׁה	**bevakasha**	please / you're welcome Does double duty: please and you are welcome.
אֵין בְּעָיָה	**ein be'aya**	no problem
אֵין בַּעַד מָה	**ein ba'ad ma**	you're welcome (lit. nothing for what) formal
סְלִיחָה	**slicha**	excuse me / sorry Used to get attention and to apologise.
אֲנִי מִצְטַעֵר	**ani mitsta'er**	I'm sorry Masculine; feminine below.
כֵּן	**ken**	yes
לֹא	**lo**	no

אוּלַי	**ulai**	maybe
בְּטַח	**betach**	sure / of course
סַבָּבָה	**sababa**	cool / great / fine by me slang Very common slang, from Arabic.
יַאלְלָה	**yalla**	come on / let's go / OK then slang From Arabic; ubiquitous.
וָואלָה	**wallah**	really? / wow / honestly slang From Arabic; tone decides the meaning.
אַחִי	**achi**	my brother (bro) slang Said to a man; to a woman friend people say achoti (my sister).
יוֹפִי	**yofi**	great / nice slang
חֲבָל עַל הַזְּמַן	**chaval al hazman**	awesome (lit. a waste of the time) slang Idiom meaning amazing; do not translate literally.
מָה פִּתְאוֹם?	**ma pitom?**	no way! / what do you mean? slang Strong disagreement.
דַּי	**dai**	enough / stop it
רֶגַע	**rega**	one moment
בְּעֶזְרַת הַשֵּׁם	**be'ezrat hashem**	God willing Common among religious speakers.
יִהְיֶה בְּסֵדֶר	**yihye beseder**	it'll be OK

Fillers and slang (23)

אָז	**az**	so Sentence opener.
נוּ	**nu**	well? / come on slang From Yiddish; prods someone to continue or hurry.
טוֹב	**tov**	OK / well / good
נָכוֹן	**nachon**	right / correct
לֹא נָכוֹן	**lo nachon**	not right / wrong
בֶּאֱמֶת?	**be'emet?**	really?

מַמָּשׁ	**mamash**	really / truly / very slang Intensifier.
פָּשׁוּט	**pashut**	simply / just
סְתָם	**stam**	just (because) / for no reason slang
בְּעֶצֶם	**be'etsem**	actually / in fact
כְּלוֹמַר	**klomar**	that is / I mean formal
אֲבָל	**aval**	but
אֲנִי לֹא יוֹדֵעַ	**ani lo yode'a**	I don't know Masculine; feminine below.
אֲנִי לֹא מֵבִין	**ani lo mevin**	I don't understand Masculine; feminine below.
אֲנִי מֵבִין	**ani mevin**	I understand Masculine; feminine below.
אַתָּה מְדַבֵּר אַנְגְּלִית?	**ata medaber anglit?**	do you speak English? Addressed to a man; to a woman use at medaberet anglit.
אֲנִי לֹא מְדַבֵּר עִבְרִית טוֹב	**ani lo medaber ivrit tov**	I don't speak Hebrew well Masculine speaker; feminine below.
אֶפְשָׁר לְדַבֵּר לְאַט?	**efshar ledaber le'at?**	can you speak slowly? Efshar is invariable: no gender forms.
אֶפְשָׁר לַחֲזוֹר עַל זֶה?	**efshar lachazor al ze?**	can you repeat that?
מָה זֶה?	**ma ze?**	what is this?
מָה זֶה אוֹמֵר?	**ma ze omer?**	what does that mean?
אֵיךְ אוֹמְרִים ... בְּעִבְרִית?	**eich omrim ... be'ivrit?**	how do you say ... in Hebrew?

אֶפְשָׁר לִכְתֹּב אֶת זֶה?	**efshar lichtov et ze?**	can you write that down?

Cafe and food (27)

שֻׁלְחָן לִשְׁנַיִם, בְּבַקָּשָׁה	**shulchan lishnayim, bevakasha**	a table for two, please
אֶפְשָׁר לִרְאוֹת אֶת הַתַּפְרִיט?	**efshar lir'ot et hatafrit?**	can I see the menu?
אֲנִי רוֹצֶה קָפֶה	**ani rotse kafe**	I would like a coffee Masculine; feminine below.
קָפֶה הָפוּךְ	**kafe hafuch**	latte-style milky coffee (lit. upside-down coffee) The standard Israeli milky coffee.
אֶסְפְּרֶסוֹ	**espresso**	espresso
קָפֶה שָׁחוֹר	**kafe shachor**	black coffee
קָפֶה עִם חָלָב	**kafe im chalav**	coffee with milk
תֵּה עִם נַעֲנָע	**te im na'ana**	tea with mint
מַיִם	**mayim**	water
מַיִם קָרִים, בְּבַקָּשָׁה	**mayim karim, bevakasha**	cold water, please
בִּירָה	**bira**	beer
יַיִן	**yayin**	wine
לְחַיִּים!	**lechayim!**	cheers!
אֶפְשָׁר לְהַזְמִין?	**efshar lehazmin?**	can I order?
אֶפְשָׁר עוֹד אֶחָד?	**efshar od echad?**	can I have another one? Use achat for a feminine noun (e.g. a pita): od achat.

חוּמוּס	**humus**	hummus
פָּלָאפֶל	**falafel**	falafel
שַׁקְשׁוּקָה	**shakshuka**	shakshuka (eggs poached in tomato sauce)
פִּיתָה	**pita**	pita bread
סָלָט	**salat**	salad
טָעִים מְאֹד	**taim meod**	very tasty
אֲנִי צִמְחוֹנִי	**ani tsimchoni**	I'm vegetarian Masculine; feminine below.
אֲנִי טִבְעוֹנִי	**ani tiv'oni**	I'm vegan Masculine; feminine below.
אֲנִי אָלֶרְגִי לְ	**ani alergi le-**	I'm allergic to ... Masculine; feminine below.
לֶאֱכֹל כָּאן אוֹ לָקַחַת?	**le'echol kan o lakachat?**	eat here or take away?
הַחֶשְׁבּוֹן, בְּבַקָּשָׁה	**hacheshbon, bevakasha**	the bill, please
אֶפְשָׁר לְשַׁלֵּם בְּכַרְטִיס?	**efshar leshalem bekartis?**	can I pay by card?

Shopping (20)

כַּמָּה זֶה עוֹלֶה?	**kama ze ole?**	how much does it cost?
מָה הַמְּחִיר?	**ma hamechir?**	what is the price?
זֶה יָקָר	**ze yakar**	it's expensive
זֶה זוֹל	**ze zol**	it's cheap
יֵשׁ הַנָּחָה?	**yesh hanacha?**	is there a discount?

אֲנִי רַק מִסְתַּכֵּל	**ani rak mistakel**	I'm just looking Masculine; feminine below.
אֶקַּח אֶת זֶה	**ekach et ze**	I'll take this
יֵשׁ לָכֶם ...?	**yesh lachem ...?**	do you have ...?
אֶפְשָׁר לִמְדֹּד?	**efshar limdod?**	can I try it on?
מָה הַמִּדָּה?	**ma hamida?**	what size?
יֵשׁ מִדָּה גְּדוֹלָה יוֹתֵר?	**yesh mida gdola yoter?**	is there a bigger size?
מְזֻמָּן	**mezuman**	cash
כַּרְטִיס אַשְׁרַאי	**kartis ashrai**	credit card
אֶפְשָׁר קַבָּלָה?	**efshar kabala?**	can I have a receipt?
אֶפְשָׁר שַׂקִּית?	**efshar sakit?**	can I have a bag?
פָּתוּחַ	**patuach**	open
סָגוּר	**sagur**	closed
מָתַי אַתֶּם סוֹגְרִים?	**matai atem sogrim?**	when do you close?
שֶׁקֶל	**shekel**	shekel (Israeli currency)
אֵיפֹה הַשֵּׁרוּתִים?	**eifo hasherutim?**	where is the restroom?

Taxi and transport (15)

אֲנִי צָרִיךְ מוֹנִית	**ani tsarich monit**	I need a taxi Masculine; feminine below.
לְאָן?	**le'an?**	where to? What the driver asks.

לִשְׂדֵה הַתְּעוּפָה, בְּבַקָּשָׁה	**lisde hate'ufa, bevakasha**	to the airport, please
לַתַּחֲנָה הַמֶּרְכָּזִית	**latachana hamerkazit**	to the central station
לַמָּלוֹן	**lamalon**	to the hotel
לַכּוֹתֶל	**lakotel**	to the Western Wall
אֶפְשָׁר מוֹנֶה, בְּבַקָּשָׁה?	**efshar moneh, bevakasha?**	can you use the meter, please? Asking for the meter is common practice.
כַּמָּה זֶה יַעֲלֶה?	**kama ze ya'ale?**	how much will it cost?
עֲצֹר כָּאן, בְּבַקָּשָׁה	**atsor kan, bevakasha**	stop here, please Masculine singular; feminine: itsri kan.
אֵיפֹה תַּחֲנַת הָאוֹטוֹבּוּס?	**eifo tachanat ha'otobus?**	where is the bus stop?
אֵיזֶה אוֹטוֹבּוּס הוֹלֵךְ לְ...?	**eize otobus holech le...?**	which bus goes to ...?
מָתַי הָרַכֶּבֶת הַבָּאָה?	**matai harakevet haba'a?**	when is the next train?
כַּרְטִיס אֶחָד לְ..., בְּבַקָּשָׁה	**kartis echad le..., bevakasha**	one ticket to ..., please
הַאִם זֶה הָאוֹטוֹבּוּס לְ...?	**ha'im ze ha'otobus le...?**	is this the bus to ...? formal
הַנְּסִיעָה הָיְתָה נָעִימָה, תּוֹדָה	**hanesi'a hayta na'ima, toda**	it was a pleasant ride, thanks

Directions (20)

אֵיפֹה ...?	**eifo ...?**	where is ...?
אֵיךְ מַגִּיעִים לְ...?	**eich magi'im le...?**	how do you get to ...?
זֶה רָחוֹק?	**ze rachok?**	is it far?
זֶה קָרוֹב	**ze karov**	it's near
יָשָׁר	**yashar**	straight ahead
שְׂמֹאלָה	**smola**	left
יָמִינָה	**yamina**	right
לֵךְ יָשָׁר	**lech yashar**	go straight To a man; to a woman: lechi yashar.
פְּנֵה שְׂמֹאלָה	**pne smola**	turn left To a man; to a woman: pni smola.
פְּנֵה יָמִינָה	**pne yamina**	turn right To a man; to a woman: pni yamina.
עַל יַד	**al yad**	next to
מוּל	**mul**	opposite
בַּפִּנָּה	**bapina**	on the corner
אֲנִי אָבוּד	**ani avud**	I'm lost Masculine; feminine below.
אֶפְשָׁר לְהַרְאוֹת לִי עַל הַמַּפָּה?	**efshar lehar'ot li al hamapa?**	can you show me on the map?
כַּמָּה זְמַן זֶה לוֹקֵחַ?	**kama zman ze lokeach?**	how long does it take?
אֵיפֹה בֵּית הַחוֹלִים?	**eifo beit hacholim?**	where is the hospital?

אֵיפֹה בֵּית הַמִּרְקַחַת?	**eifo beit hamirkachat?**	where is the pharmacy?
אֵיפֹה הַמָּלוֹן?	**eifo hamalon?**	where is the hotel?
אֵיפֹה הַתַּחֲנָה?	**eifo hatachana?**	where is the station?

Numbers (22)

אֶחָד	**echad**	one (1) Masculine; feminine achat. Counting aloud uses feminine forms.
שְׁנַיִם	**shnayim**	two (2) Masculine; feminine shtayim.
שְׁלוֹשָׁה	**shlosha**	three (3) Masculine; feminine shalosh.
אַרְבָּעָה	**arba'a**	four (4) Masculine; feminine arba.
חֲמִשָּׁה	**chamisha**	five (5) Masculine; feminine chamesh.
שִׁשָּׁה	**shisha**	six (6) Masculine; feminine shesh.
שִׁבְעָה	**shiv'a**	seven (7) Masculine; feminine sheva.
שְׁמוֹנָה	**shmona**	eight (8) Masculine; feminine shmone.
תִּשְׁעָה	**tish'a**	nine (9) Masculine; feminine tesha.
עֲשָׂרָה	**asara**	ten (10) Masculine; feminine eser.
עֶשְׂרִים	**esrim**	twenty (20)
שְׁלוֹשִׁים	**shloshim**	thirty (30)
חֲמִשִּׁים	**chamishim**	fifty (50)
מֵאָה	**me'a**	one hundred (100)
אֶלֶף	**elef**	one thousand (1000)

מָה הַשָּׁעָה?	**ma hasha'a?**	what time is it?
הַשָּׁעָה שָׁלוֹשׁ	**hasha'a shalosh**	it's three o'clock Hours use the feminine numbers.
חֲצִי	**chetsi**	half
רֶבַע	**reva**	quarter
הַיּוֹם	**hayom**	today
מָחָר	**machar**	tomorrow
אֶתְמוֹל	**etmol**	yesterday

Small talk (19)

מַה שִּׁמְךָ?	**ma shimcha?**	what's your name? To a man; to a woman: ma shmech?
קוֹרְאִים לִי ...	**kor'im li ...**	my name is ... (lit. they call me ...)
מֵאֵיפֹה אַתָּה?	**me'eifo ata?**	where are you from? To a man; to a woman: me'eifo at?
אֲנִי מִקָּנָדָה	**ani mikanada**	I'm from Canada Same for men and women.
אֲנִי תַּיָּר	**ani tayar**	I'm a tourist Masculine; feminine below.
זֹאת הַפַּעַם הָרִאשׁוֹנָה שֶׁלִּי בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל	**zot hapa'am harishona sheli beyisrael**	it's my first time in Israel
מָה אַתָּה עוֹשֶׂה?	**ma ata ose?**	what do you do (for work)? To a man; to a woman: ma at osa?
בֶּן כַּמָּה אַתָּה?	**ben kama ata?**	how old are you? (lit. son of how much) To a man; to a woman: bat kama at?
אֲנִי רָעֵב	**ani ra'ev**	I'm hungry Masculine; feminine below.
אֲנִי צָמֵא	**ani tsame**	I'm thirsty Masculine; feminine below.

אֲנִי עָיֵף	**ani ayef**	I'm tired Masculine; feminine below.
חַם לִי	**cham li**	I'm hot
קַר לִי	**kar li**	I'm cold
הַכֹּל בְּסֵדֶר אִתְּךָ?	**hakol beseder itcha?**	are you OK? To a man; to a woman: itach.
תִּרְגַּע	**tirga**	chill / calm down slang To a man; to a woman: tirgi (or tirga'i).
מָה הַמַּצָּב?	**ma hamatsav?**	how's it going? (lit. what's the situation) slang
אֵין מָה לַעֲשׂוֹת	**ein ma la'asot**	there's nothing to be done
חָבֵר	**chaver**	friend Masculine; feminine chavera.
אֶתְגַּעְגֵּעַ אֵלַיִךְ	**etga'age'a elecha**	I'll miss you To a man; to a woman: elaich.

Help (9)

עֶזְרָה!	**ezra!**	help!
אֲנִי צָרִיךְ רוֹפֵא	**ani tsarich rofe**	I need a doctor Masculine; feminine below.
תִּקְרָא לַמִּשְׁטָרָה	**tikra lamishtara**	call the police To a man; to a woman: tikri.
תִּקְרָא לְאַמְבּוּלַנְס	**tikra le'ambulans**	call an ambulance To a man; to a woman: tikre'i.
אָבַד לִי הַדַּרְכּוֹן	**avad li hadarkon**	I lost my passport
אָבַד לִי הַטֶּלֶפוֹן	**avad li hatelefon**	I lost my phone
אֲנִי לֹא מַרְגִּישׁ טוֹב	**ani lo margish tov**	I don't feel well Masculine; feminine below.
יֵשׁ לִי כְּאֵב רֹאשׁ	**yesh li ke'ev rosh**	I have a headache
אֶפְשָׁר לְהִשְׁתַּמֵּשׁ בַּטֶּלֶפוֹן שֶׁלְּךָ?	**efshar lehishtamesh batelefon shelcha?**	can I use your phone? To a man; to a woman: shelach.

Index

Letters

Alef א 7
Ayin ע 22
Bet / Vet ב 8
Chet ח 14
Dalet ד 10
Fe sofit ף 32
Gimel ג 9
He ה 11
Kaf / Khaf כ 17
Khaf sofit ך 29
Kof ק 25
Lamed ל 18
Mem מ 19
Mem sofit ם 30
Nun נ 20
Nun sofit ן 31
Pe / Fe פ 23
Resh ר 26
Samekh ס 21
Shin / Sin ש 27
Tav ת 28
Tet ט 15
Tsadi צ 24
Tsadi sofit ץ 33
Vav ו 12
Yod י 16
Zayin ז 13

Vowels and marks

Chataf kamatz בֳ 40
Chataf patach בֲ 40
Chataf segol בֱ 40
Chirik בִ 39
Cholam בֹ 39
Dagesh בּ 40
Kamatz (kamatz gadol) בָ 39
Kubutz בֻ 39
Patach בַ 39
Segol בֶ 39
Shin dot שׁ 40
Shuruk בּוּ 39
Shva בְ 40
Sin dot שׂ 40
Tzere בֵ 39

Prayers and verses

Adon Olam 57
Adonai oz l'amo yiten (closing line of Ein Kamocha) 49
Aleinu, first paragraph 56
Amidah first blessing, closing (Magen Avraham) 54
Amidah opening (Avot) 54
Amidah preface: open my lips 54
Ashrei ha-am she-kacha lo (second line of Ashrei) 62
Ashrei yoshvei veitecha (first line of Ashrei) 62
Barchu (call to the Torah blessing) 51
Baruch kevod Adonai mimkomo (Kedushah) 55
Baruch shem (said after Shema line) 45
Berich shmei (Aramaic prayer when the ark is opened) 50
Birkat Hagomel (after recovery or safe travel) and the congregation's response 53
Birkat Hamazon opener (HaZan et haolam) 64
Blessing formula (Baruch atah Adonai Eloheinu Melech ha'olam) 47
Blessing over wine 59
Ein Kamocha (opening line of the Torah-ark prayer) 49
El na refa na lah (Moses' prayer for healing) 47
Elohai netzor (private prayer ending the Amidah) 56
Etz chaim hi (sung as the Torah is returned to the ark) 53
Gadlu l'Adonai iti (leader invites the congregation to magnify) 50
Haftarah blessings after the reading (Shabbat) 52
Haftarah blessings before the reading 52
HaMotzi (blessing over bread) 47
Hanerot halalu (said while lighting Hanukkah candles) 65
Hanukkah: blessing to light the candles 65
Hanukkah: sheasah nissim (who performed miracles) 65
Hashivenu (sung as the Torah is returned; 'Chadesh yameinu kekedem') 53
Havdalah: blessing over spices (besamim) 61
Havdalah: blessing over the flame 62
Havdalah: Hamavdil bein kodesh lechol 62
Hinei El yeshuati (opening of Havdalah) 61
Kadosh, kadosh, kadosh (Kedushah) 54
Kiddush (Shabbat verses) 60
Kiddush for Shabbat evening (the sanctification blessing) 59
Lecha Adonai hagedulah (carrying the Torah around) 50
Lecha Dodi (refrain and first verse) 59
Mah Tovu (first verse) 48
Malchutcha (second line of Ein Kamocha) 49
Maoz Tzur (first verse) 65
Mi Chamocha 48
Mi sheberach avoteinu (opening words only) 52
Modeh Ani (on waking) 48
Mourner's Kaddish 57
Oseh shalom (end of the Amidah and of Kaddish) 56
Poteach et yadecha (the verse said with concentration in Ashrei) 63
Priestly Blessing, line 1 46
Priestly Blessing, line 2 47
Priestly Blessing, line 3 47
Shabbat candle blessing 60
Shehecheyanu (first-time and festival blessing) 48
Shema and V'ahavta (Deut 6:4-9) 45

Shema Yisrael 45
Shir hamaalot (sung before Birkat Hamazon on Shabbat and festivals) 63
Sim shalom (peace blessing of the morning Amidah) 55
Tehilah l'David (Psalm 145, opening verses of Ashrei) 63
Torah blessing (after reading) 51
Torah blessing (before reading/study) 51
V'ahavta 46
V'ahavta, verse 1 46
V'ahavta, verses 2-3 46
V'shamru (Shabbat-day Kiddush; also in the Shabbat Amidah) 60
V'zot haTorah (said when the Torah is lifted) 51
Vayehi binsoa ha-aron (opening the ark) 49
Yehalelu (said as the Torah is returned to the ark) 53
Yigdal (hymn of the Thirteen Principles) 58
Yihyu leratzon imrei fi (verse that closes the Amidah) 55
Yimloch Adonai l'olam (Kedushah) 55
Zachor et yom hashabbat (Shabbat-day Kiddush, second passage) 61
Zimun: "Rabotai nevarech" and the response 64

Survival phrases by situation

Greetings 66
Politeness 67
Fillers and slang 68
Cafe and food 70
Shopping 71
Taxi and transport 72
Directions 74
Numbers 75
Small talk 76
Help 77

Topics

Pronunciation traditions 4
Syllable practice 41
Practice words 42
Priestly Blessing, word by word 44
Remember every letter (mnemonic cards) 34
How to use this book 3

Colophon, sources and statuses

Draft proof generated by book/build.mjs; letters data: data/letters/letters.json. Hebrew print face: Noto Serif Hebrew; handwriting: Gveret Levin; fallback Frank Ruhl Libre (all SIL Open Font License 1.1; licence texts for all three are in assets/fonts/*-OFL.txt and docs/licenses/; the Noto Serif Hebrew text is byte-identical to google/fonts ofl/notoserifhebrew/OFL.txt, fetched 2026-11-03). QR codes made with segno (BSD-3).

What is placeholder: every illustration is a labelled placeholder (no AI images have been generated); audio recordings do not exist yet (the app falls back to a device voice); the opening prayer is a draft pending clergy review; prayer texts and the phrasebook are not proofread by native speakers; stroke data for handwriting is draft quality; the companion-app host alef.example.org is a placeholder domain.

Text attributions (from the registry)

Hebrew text: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026), Tanach.us Inc., West Redding, CT, USA (tanach.us; "may be viewed or copied without restriction"). Cantillation marks removed. Not the WLC. English: JPS 1917, public domain.

Hebrew text: The Metsudah siddur (Metsudah Publications, 1981), as digitised on Sefaria where it is labelled CC-BY. Attribute to Metsudah Publications and credit Sefaria as the source. THE LICENCE LABEL IS SEFARIA'S AND IS NOT INDEPENDENTLY VERIFIED. English: original literal gloss.

Hebrew text: Siddur Edot HaMizrach, "Shaliehsaboo Edition", from Sefaria where it is labelled CC0 (no attribution required; credit given as a courtesy). Label not independently verified. English: original literal gloss.

Hebrew text: Unicode/XML Leningrad Codex (UXLC) UXLC 2.6 (file dated 19 Oct 2026), Tanach.us Inc., West Redding, CT, USA (tanach.us; "may be viewed or copied without restriction"). Cantillation marks removed. Not the WLC. English: original literal gloss.

Hebrew text: Torat Emet 357 (toratemetfreeware.com), as digitised on Sefaria where it is labelled Public Domain. Label not independently verified. English: original literal gloss.

Image credit line (use once real images replace placeholders): Illustrations created with AI tools and edited by the author.